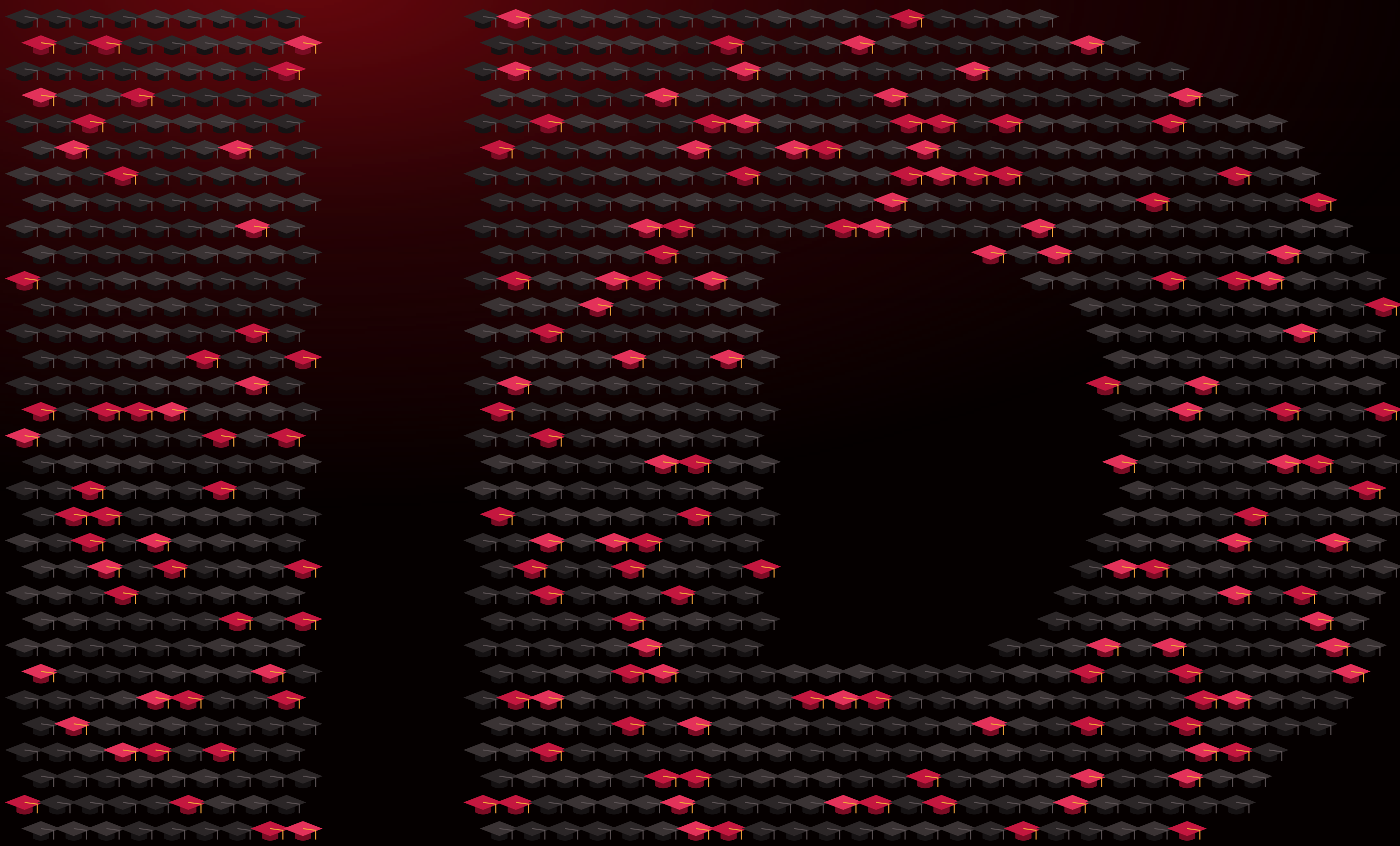
NOVEMBER 2026

The 2026 Idaho Talent Profile

Emerson Johnston
Amy Zegart

The bright caps, **18 in every 100**, mark the international share of Idaho's STEM master's degrees.



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The 2026
Idaho
Talent Profile

By Emerson Johnston and Amy Zegart

NOVEMBER 2026

A publication jointly produced by the Hoover Institution and the Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence at Stanford University.

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Data come from the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), the Department of Homeland Security's SEVIS by the Numbers, the National Assessment of Educational Progress, NSF's Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates and Survey of Earned Doctorates, the Department of Labor's Office of Foreign Labor Certification, the USCIS H-1B Employer Data Hub, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and USPTO patent data via PatentsView, processed in Python; every figure and table is generated from those sources, and each one names its source.

About This Profile

This profile is a companion to *The 2026 US Talent Report: Benchmarking America's STEM Pipeline Amid the Great Talent Competition*. It applies the report's measures to Idaho: the students the state develops at home, those it draws from abroad, and how both compare with the nation and with the states closest to it in size.

Degrees, enrollment, prices, outcomes and faculty come from IPEDS, the federal census of U.S. colleges and universities, harmonized across 1980–2025. Countries of citizenship come from SEVIS by the Numbers, the Department of Homeland Security's monthly count of active F-1 and M-1 students. Each figure names its source. Peer states are the four closest in total fall enrollment.

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Public Data and Tools

The data behind every chart come from the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), published by the National Center for Education Statistics, and from SEVIS by the Numbers, published by the Department of Homeland Security's Student and Exchange Visitor Program. An interactive version of this profile accompanies the report.

To share any charts and figures, proper attribution is required. This profile is licensed under Attribution-NoDerivatives 4.0 International (CC BY-ND 4.0). Please cite as: The 2026 Idaho Talent Profile.

AT A GLANCE

What Idaho's numbers say

1. **International students earn 18% of Idaho's STEM master's degrees,** 34.0 points below the U.S. (52%) in 2025, ranking 44th of 51 on dependence. The share is 32% for STEM research doctorates (U.S. 43%) and 4.8% for STEM bachelor's (U.S. 6.6%).
2. **Idaho awarded 78 STEM master's degrees to international students in 2025,** 0.1% of the U.S. total and 44th of 51 among states. Since 2015 the count changed +50%, against 2.2× nationally.
3. **The heaviest dependence is in engineering,** where international students earned 30% of master's degrees (96 degrees; U.S. 49%). No STEM field with at least 50 master's graduates are majority-international.
4. **Among states of similar size,** Idaho ranks 4th of 5 on the international share of STEM master's: Idaho 18%, West Virginia 10%, Nebraska 25%, Nevada 30%, New Mexico 31%.
5. **54% of Idaho's first-time students in fall 2024 were state residents** and 13% came from abroad. More students arrived from other states (6.43K) than residents left (3.66K), a net gain of 2.77K; the top destination for those leaving was Utah.

18%

of the STEM master's degrees Idaho awards go to international students (U.S. 52%).

SCORECARD

Nine numbers against the nation

136K #38
Students enrolled, 2024
U.S. **19.7M** · +12% since 2015

78 #44
International STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **117K** · +50% since 2015

18% #44
International share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · +3.8 pp since 2015

6.9% #44
International share of grad students, 2024
U.S. **17%** · +0.1 pp since 2015

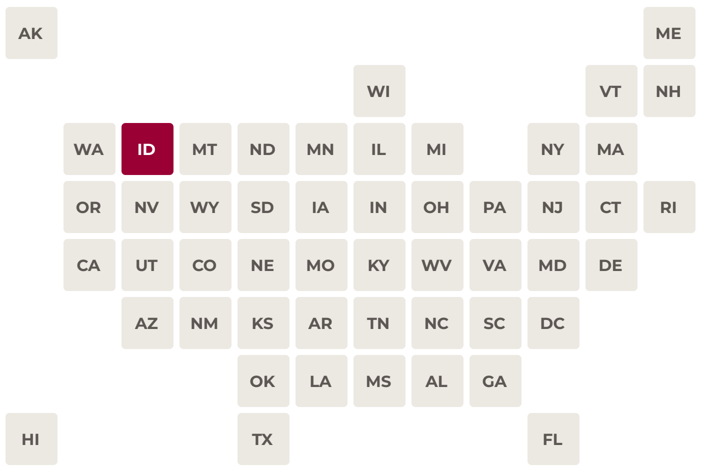
22% #27
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · +2.9 pp since 2015

53% #47
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · +9.2 pp since 2015

$11K #26
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11.4K** · +11% since 2015

54% #46
First-time students from in state, 2024
U.S. **–** · −6.0 pp since 2016

$81.4K #44
Average faculty salary, 2024
U.S. **$106K** · −4.6% since 2016



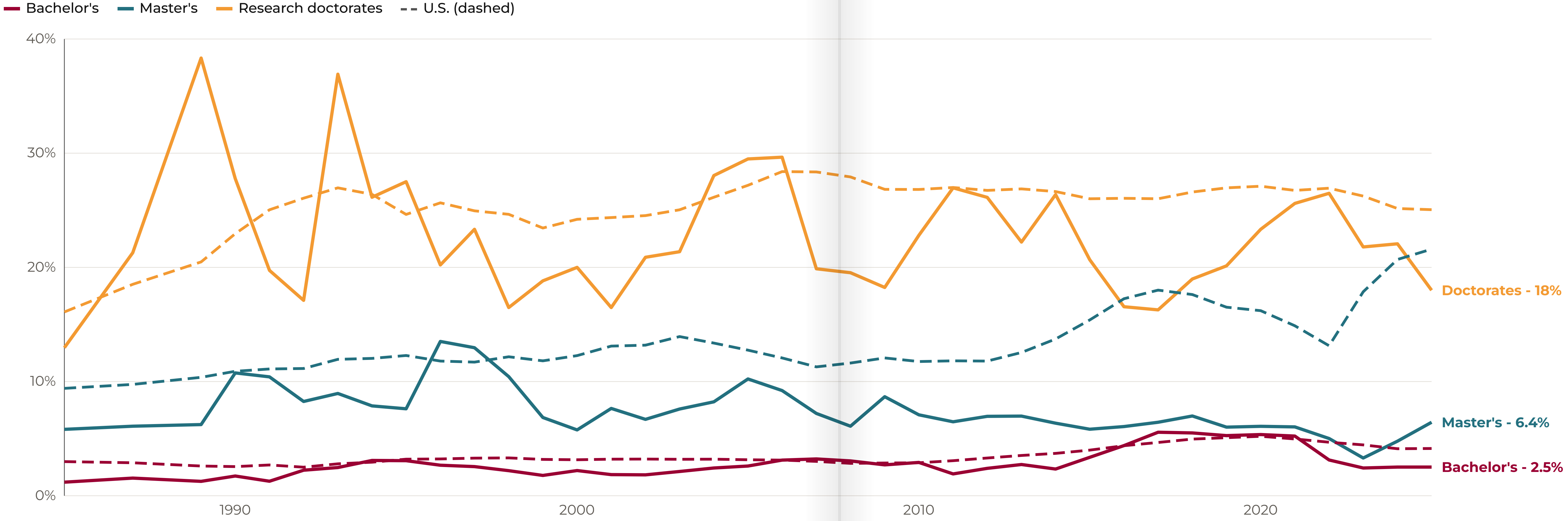
Badges give Idaho's rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Changes are since 2015.

SECTION 1

International Dependence

Idaho ranks 45th of 51 states on the international share of all master's, at 6.4% in 2025 against 22% for the U.S.

Figure 1 What Share of Idaho's Degrees Go to International Students?



International share of degrees awarded, all fields; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions, 1985–2025.

International students make up 6.9% of Idaho's graduate enrollment and 2.1% of its undergraduates. Dependence climbs with each degree: 2.5% of bachelor's, 6.4% of master's and 18% of research doctorates go to international students.

In STEM the shares are higher still: 4.8% of STEM bachelor's, 18% of STEM master's and 32% of STEM doctorates. The state awards 0.1% of all U.S. international STEM master's, 44th of 51.

6.9%

Int. share of grad students, 2024

U.S. **17%** · **44th** of 51 · +0.1 pp since 2015

6.4%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

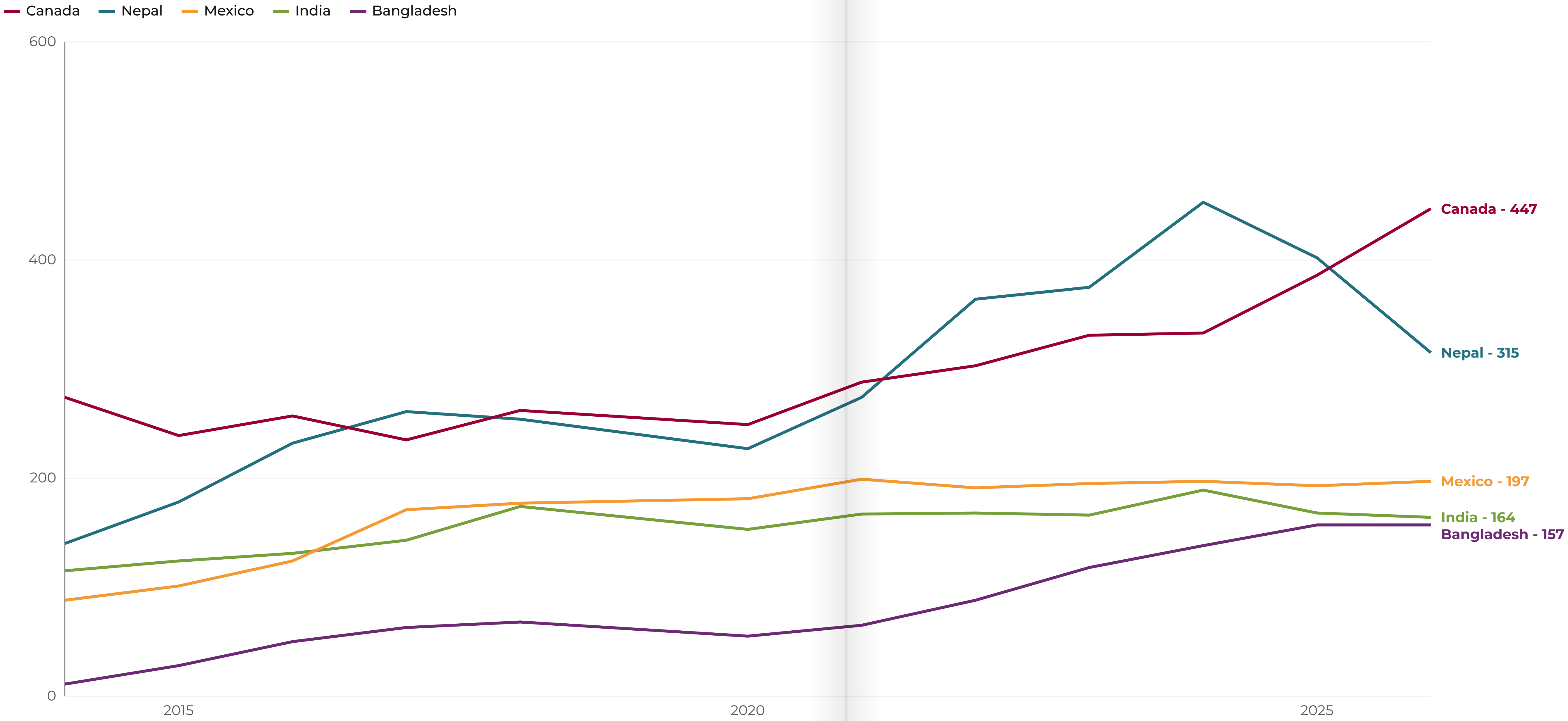
U.S. **22%** · **45th** of 51 · +0.6 pp since 2015

18%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **52%** · **44th** of 51 · +3.8 pp since 2015

Figure 2 Where Do Idaho's International Students Come From?



Active F-1 and M-1 students by country of citizenship, the five largest in October 2026; one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November), October 2014–October 2026. All education levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers.

In October 2026, Idaho had 3.47K active international students in SEVIS, 40th of 51. Canada accounted for 13% of them and Nepal for 9.1%, against 3.3% and 2.9% nationally.

Students came from 146 countries, but the two largest supplied 22%. The state's total is down 19% since 2014.

3.47K
Active international students, October 2026
40th of 51 · U.S. **1.19M**

13%
From Canada
U.S. **3.3%**

65%
In STEM fields
U.S. **63%**

SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

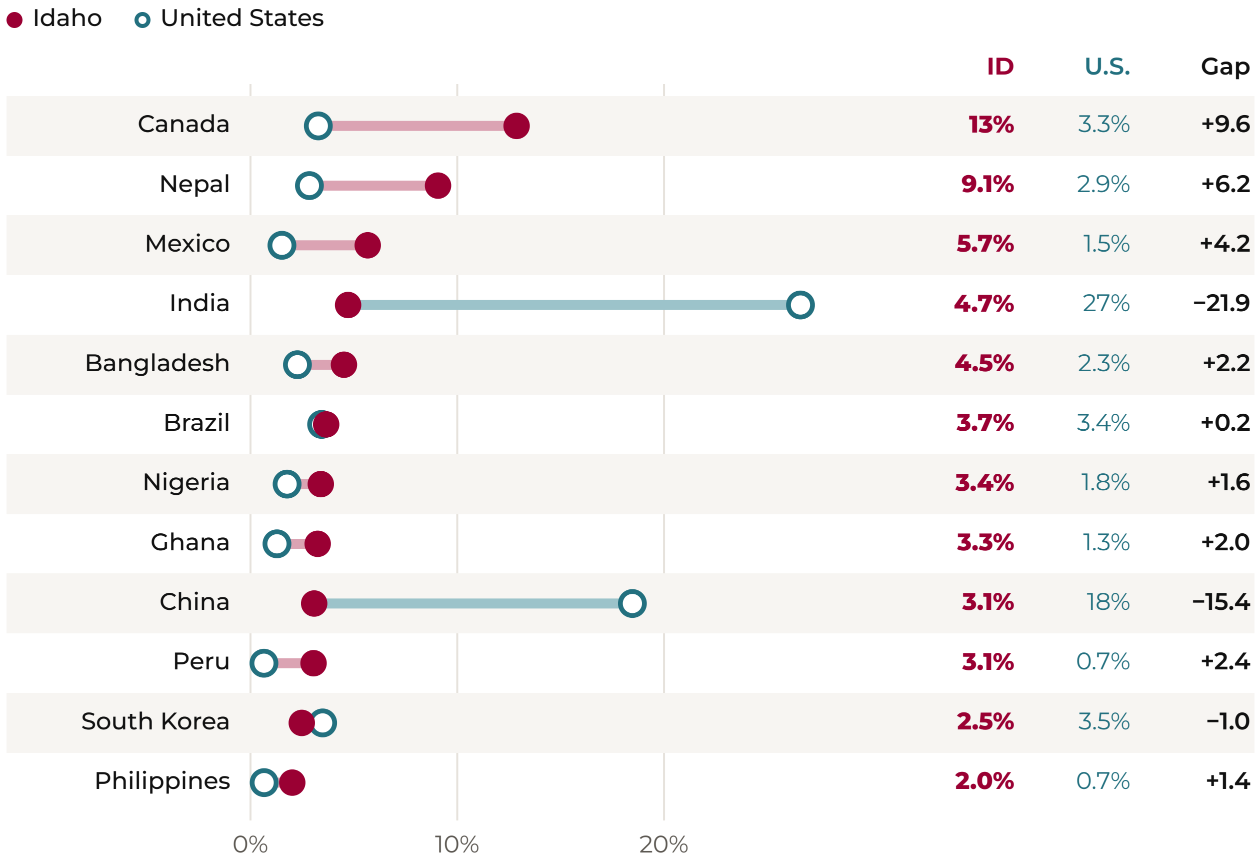
How Does Idaho's Mix of Countries Compare With the Nation's?

In October 2026, Idaho had **3.47K** active F-1 and M-1 students, 40th of 51 states and **0.3%** of the U.S. total. They came from 146 countries.

Canada supplied **13%** of them, against 3.3% nationally, and Nepal **9.1%**, against 2.9%. Mexico (5.7%), India (4.7%), and Bangladesh (4.5%) followed.

Together the two largest countries supplied **22%** of the state's international students (U.S. 45%), 44th among the states, against 44% in 2015.

Figure 3 Is Idaho's Mix of Countries Like the Nation's?



	ID	U.S.	Gap
Canada	13%	3.3%	+9.6
Nepal	9.1%	2.9%	+6.2
Mexico	5.7%	1.5%	+4.2
India	4.7%	27%	−21.9
Bangladesh	4.5%	2.3%	+2.2
Brazil	3.7%	3.4%	+0.2
Nigeria	3.4%	1.8%	+1.6
Ghana	3.3%	1.3%	+2.0
China	3.1%	18%	−15.4
Peru	3.1%	0.7%	+2.4
South Korea	2.5%	3.5%	−1.0
Philippines	2.0%	0.7%	+1.4

Share of active F-1 and M-1 students, all levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

3.47K
Active international students, October 2026
40th of 51 · U.S. **1.19M**

13%
From Canada
U.S. **3.3%**

9.1%
From Nepal
U.S. **2.9%**

146
Countries represented
U.S. **219**

The state's count is down 2.3% from 2025 and down 22% since 2015, when it stood at 4.43K. Its share of all U.S. international students is down 0.1 points since 2015, to **0.3%**.

Since 2015, the number of students from Canada went from 239 to 447, Nepal's from 178 to 315, and Mexico's from 101 to 197.

Over the same years, the number from India went from 124 to 164 and Bangladesh's from 28 to 157. The table gives each country's count for the first, previous and latest years.

Table 1 International Students in Idaho, 2015–2026

	2015	2025	2026	Change since 2015	U.S. 2026	Rank
ALL INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS						
Active F-1 and M-1 students	4.43K	3.55K	**3.47K**	−22%	1.19M	40th
Share of U.S. active F-1/M-1 students	0.4%	0.3%	**0.3%**	−0.1 pp	–	40th
Countries of citizenship represented	138	142	**146**	+5.8%	219	37th
Share from the two largest countries of origin	44%	22%	**22%**	−22.4 pp	45%	44th
LARGEST COUNTRIES OF CITIZENSHIP (STUDENTS)					**U.S. SHARE**	**STATE SHARE**
Canada	239	386	**447**	+87%	3.3%	13%
Nepal	178	402	**315**	+77%	2.9%	9.1%
Mexico	101	193	**197**	+95%	1.5%	5.7%
India	124	168	**164**	+32%	27%	4.7%
Bangladesh	28	157	**157**	–	2.3%	4.5%

Active F-1 and M-1 students, one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November; 2019 has none; the latest year is October 2026). Rank among the 50 states and DC. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers.

Figure 4

Which Countries Supply Idaho's International STEM Students?

2.26K of Idaho's international students were in STEM fields in October 2026, **65%** of the total against 63% nationally, up 1.5% since 2015.

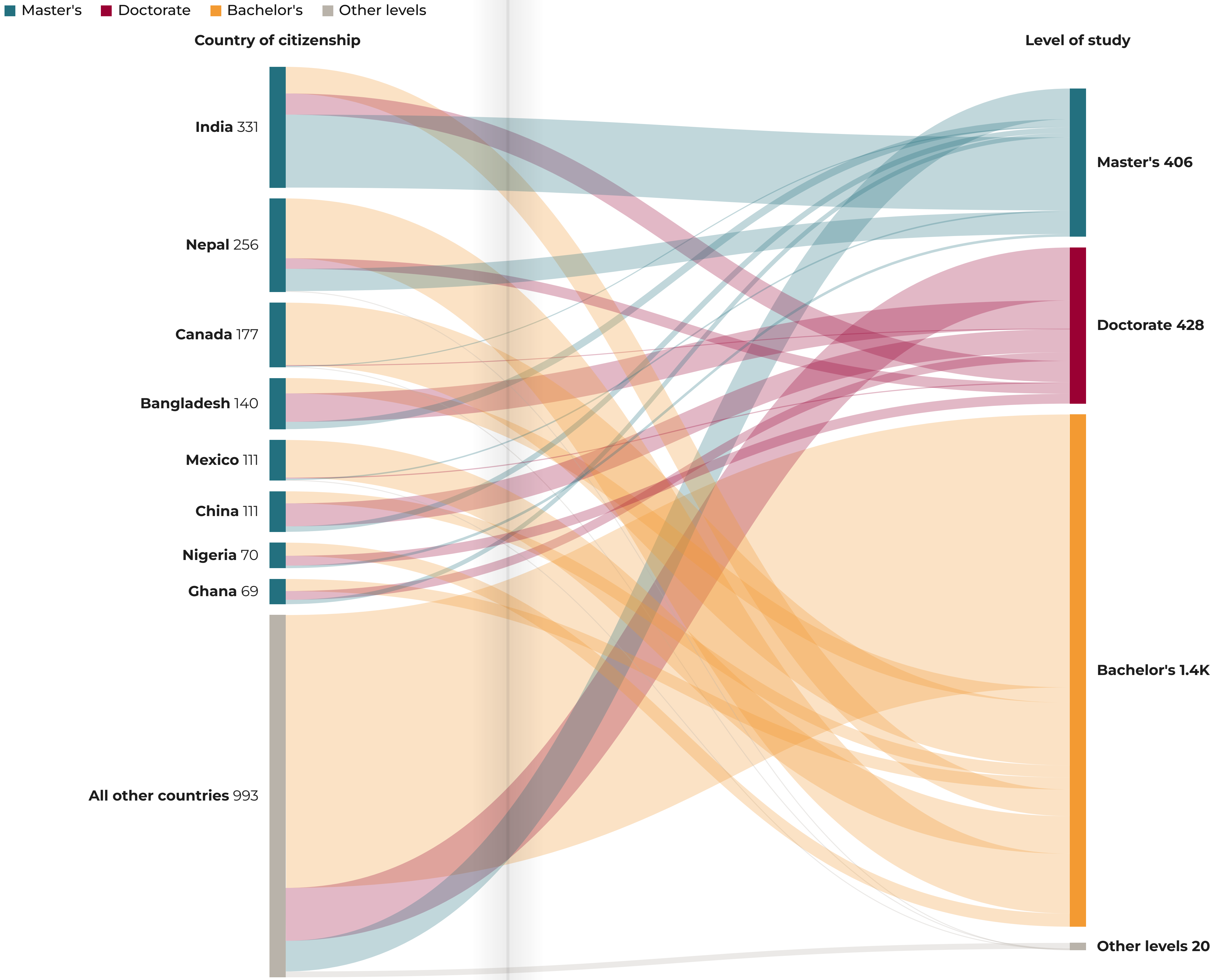
Bachelor's students were the largest group, **1.4K**. Canada supplied 12% of them and Nepal 12%.

STEM doctoral students went from 166 in 2015 to **428**, and STEM master's students from 179 to 406.

2.26K
Active STEM F-1/M-1 students, 2026
U.S. **749K** · **41st** of 51 · +1.5% since 2015

65%
Share in STEM fields
U.S. **63%**

406
Active STEM master's students, 2026
U.S. **393K** · **44th** of 51 · 2.27× since 2015



Active F-1 and M-1 students in STEM fields by country of citizenship and level of study, October 2026; the eight largest countries are shown. DHS does not draw its STEM pages on the same basis as its all-student pages, so the STEM count here exceeds the all-level count for India (331 against 164), China (111 against 107). Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

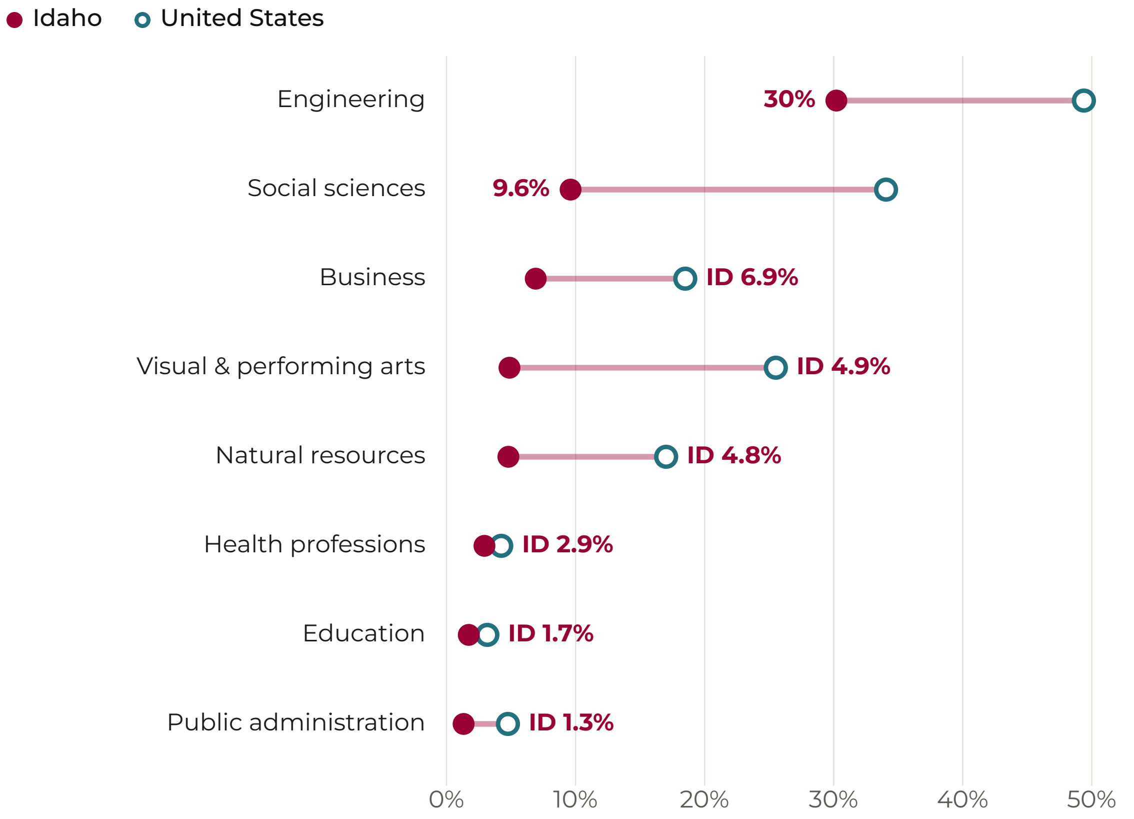
SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

How International Are Idaho's Master's Fields?

Each row is a master's field with at least 30 graduates in Idaho in 2025, ranked by the share of degrees earned by international students (U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas). The filled dot is the state's share; the open dot is the national share for the same field.

Highest international shares. International students earned the largest shares of master's degrees in engineering (30%, against 49% for the U.S.), social sciences (9.6%, against 34% for the U.S.), and business (6.9%, against 19% for the U.S.).

Figure 5 **Which Master's Fields Depend Most on International Students?**



International share of master's degrees by field, 2025; fields with 30+ graduates. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

6.4%
Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **45th** of 51

18%
Int. share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · **44th** of 51

49%
Int. share of CS master's, 2025
U.S. **65%** · **31st** of 47

The table gives the international share of degrees in each STEM field at three levels: Idaho first, the United States after the slash. The master's column is highlighted. A dash means the state awarded no degrees in the field at that level.

Highest international share among STEM master's fields. International students earned 30% of the master's degrees in engineering, against 49% for the U.S.

Table 2 **How International Is Each STEM Field?**

Field	Bachelor's	Master's	Doctorates
Computer & info sciences	6.3% / 8.6%	**49% / 65%**	– / 56%
Engineering	5.1% / 7.2%	**30% / 49%**	24% / 55%
Engineering technology	2.5% / 4.5%	**– / 54%**	– / 42%
Math & statistics	9.4% / 17%	**– / 55%**	– / 53%
Physical sciences	2.2% / 6.0%	**16% / 33%**	– / 38%
Biological sciences	3.2% / 3.4%	**11% / 23%**	29% / 23%
Natural resources	2.1% / 2.0%	**4.8% / 17%**	– / 27%
Architecture	11% / 7.3%	**10% / 29%**	– / 55%

International share in Idaho / U.S., 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

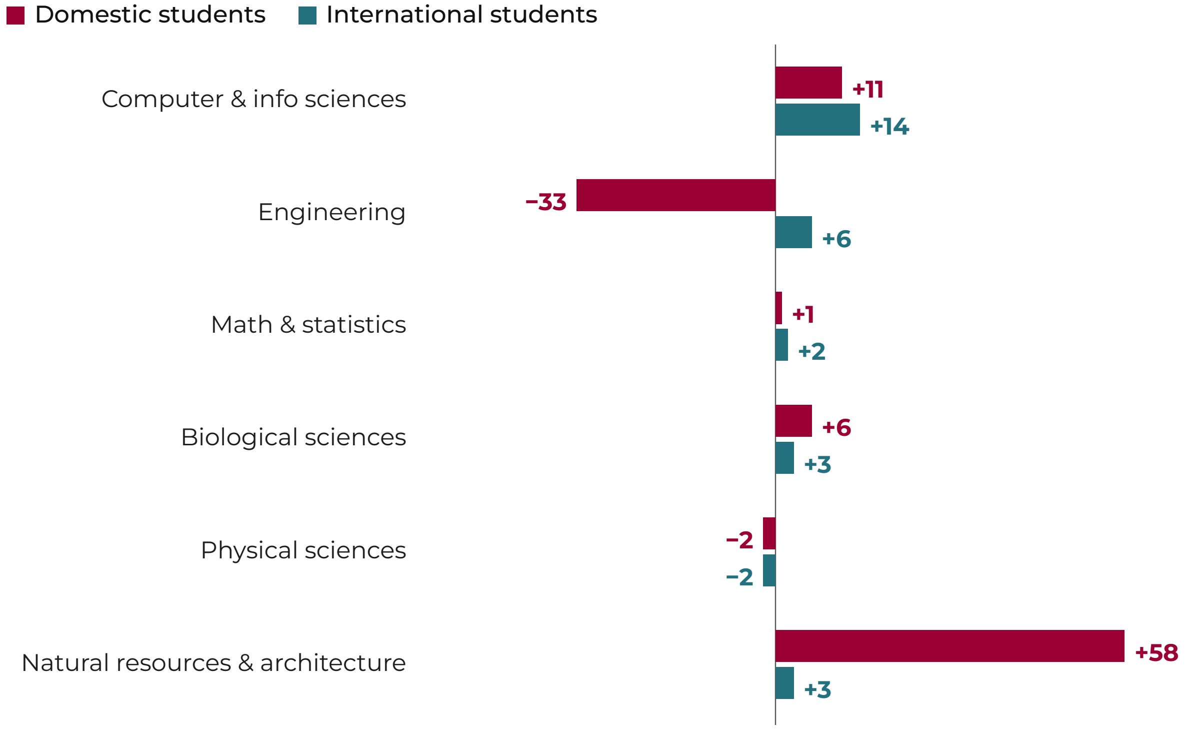
SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

How Has Idaho's STEM Master's Output Grown?

Each pair of bars is the change in the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in Idaho between 2015 and 2025 in one field: to domestic students (U.S. citizens and permanent residents) and to international students. Bars to the left of the axis are declines.

STEM master's degrees. The state awarded 431 in 2025 and 364 in 2015, a change of +26 for international students and +41 for domestic students.

Figure 6 Where Did the STEM Master's Growth Come From?



Change in STEM master's degrees by field, 2015–2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

78
International STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **117K** · **44th** of 51

18%
STEM share of master's, 2025
U.S. **23%** · **31st** of 51

0.1%
Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025
44th of 51

4.7
STEM master's per doctorate, 2025
U.S. **6.4** · **34th** of 51

The table gives the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in Idaho in each field in 2015 and 2025, the change between the two years, the number awarded to international students in 2025, and international students' share of the field's degrees in each year.

STEM share of master's degrees. The share was 18% in 2025, against 23% for the U.S., 31st among the states, up 0.7 points from 18% in 2024 and down 0.4 points since 2015, when it was 19%.

Table 3 How Many STEM Master's Degrees Does Each Field Award?

Field	2015	2025	Change	International 2025	Int. share 2015	Int. share 2025
Computer & info sciences	20	**45**	–	22	–	49%
Engineering	139	**112**	−19%	31	18%	28%
Math & statistics	16	**19**	–	5	–	–
Biological sciences	28	**37**	–	4	–	11%
Physical sciences	36	**32**	–	5	19%	16%
Natural resources & architecture	125	**186**	+49%	11	6.4%	5.9%

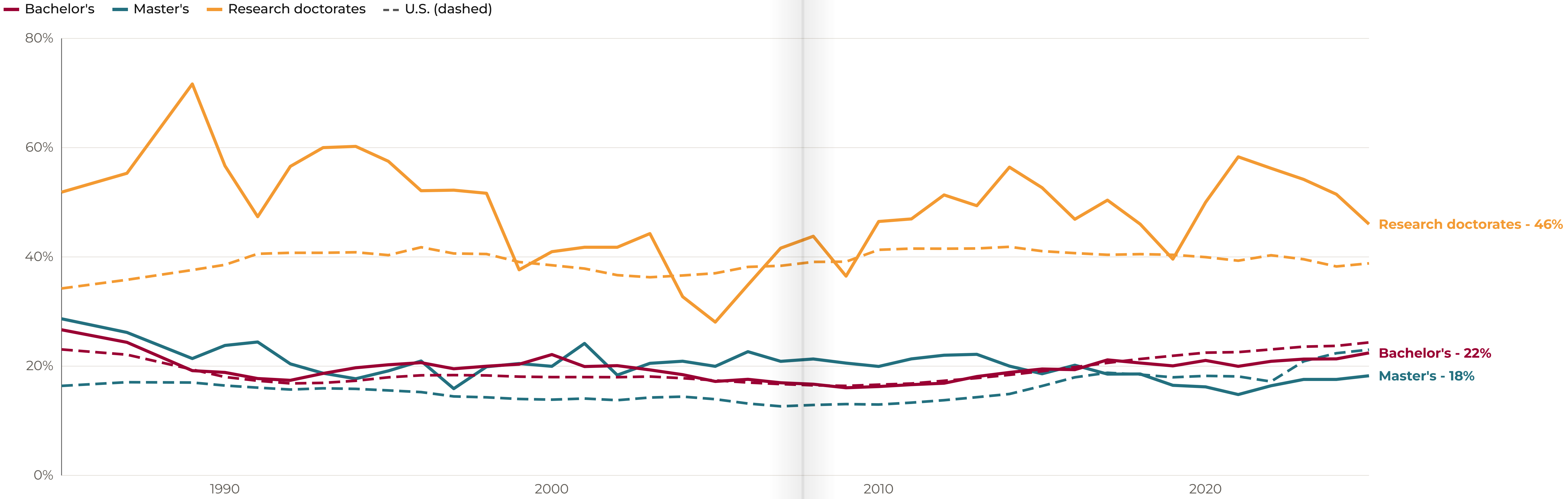
STEM master's degrees awarded in Idaho, all students and international students, 2015 and 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

SECTION 2

STEM Degrees

Idaho ranks 16th of 51 states on the STEM share of research doctorates, at 46% in 2025 against 39% for the U.S.

Figure 7 How Much of Idaho's Degree Output Is STEM?



STEM share of degrees by level; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

STEM fields account for 22% of Idaho's bachelor's degrees, 18% of its master's and 46% of its research doctorates (U.S. 24%, 23% and 39%).

The STEM share of master's degrees is down 0.4 points since 2015, and the state ranks 31st of 51 on it. On the STEM share of bachelor's degrees it ranks 27th of 51.

22%

STEM share of bachelor's, 2025

U.S. **24%** · **27th** of 51 · +2.9 pp since 2015

18%

STEM share of master's, 2025

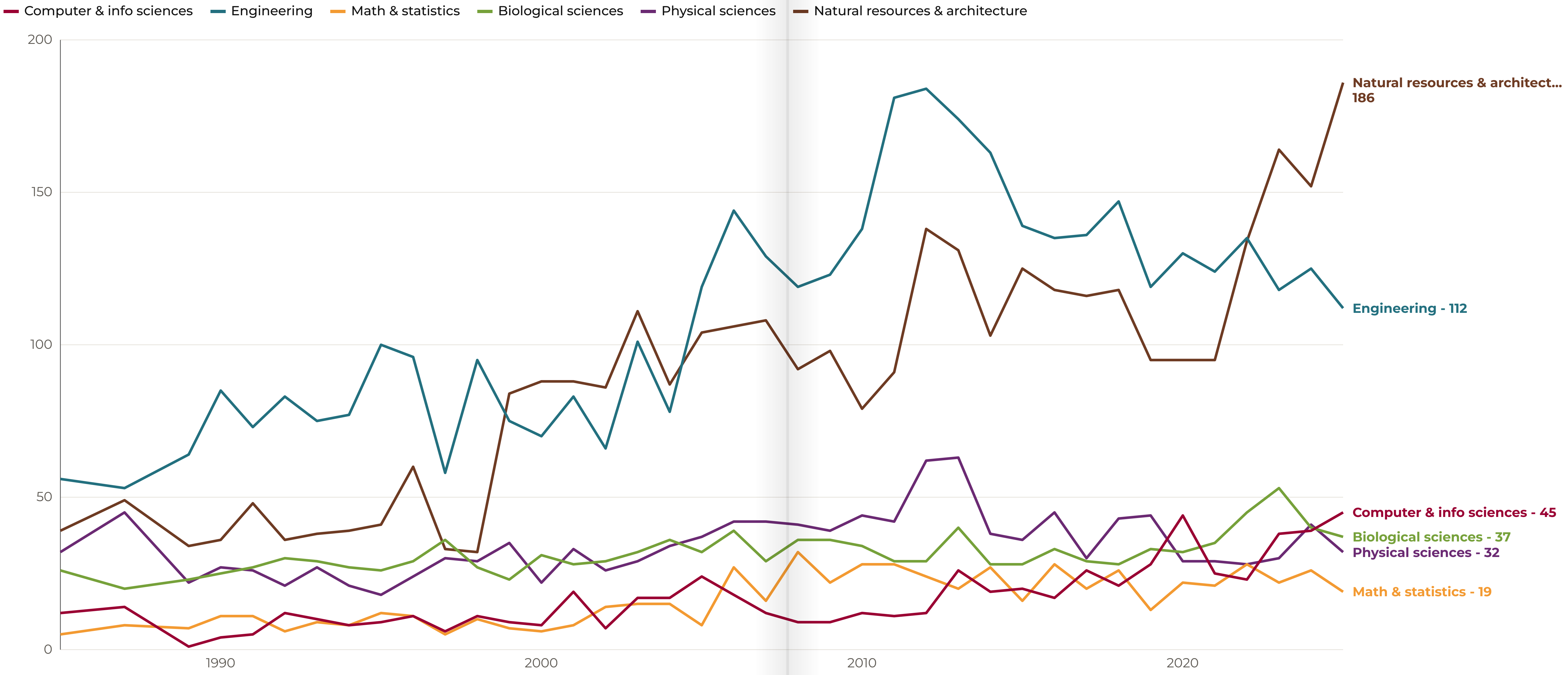
U.S. **23%** · **31st** of 51 · −0.4 pp since 2015

46%

STEM share of research doctorates, 2025

U.S. **39%** · **16th** of 51 · −6.7 pp since 2015

Figure 8 **Which STEM Fields Produce Idaho's Master's Degrees?**



STEM master's degrees by field, all students. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Natural resources & architecture produced the most STEM master's degrees in 2025, 186, followed by engineering (112) and computer & info sciences (45). Master's degrees in natural resources & architecture are up 49% since 2015.

International students earned 78 of the state's STEM master's degrees in 2025, 0.1% of the national total (44th of 51).

78

International STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **117K** · **44th** of 51 · +50% since 2015

0.1%

Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025

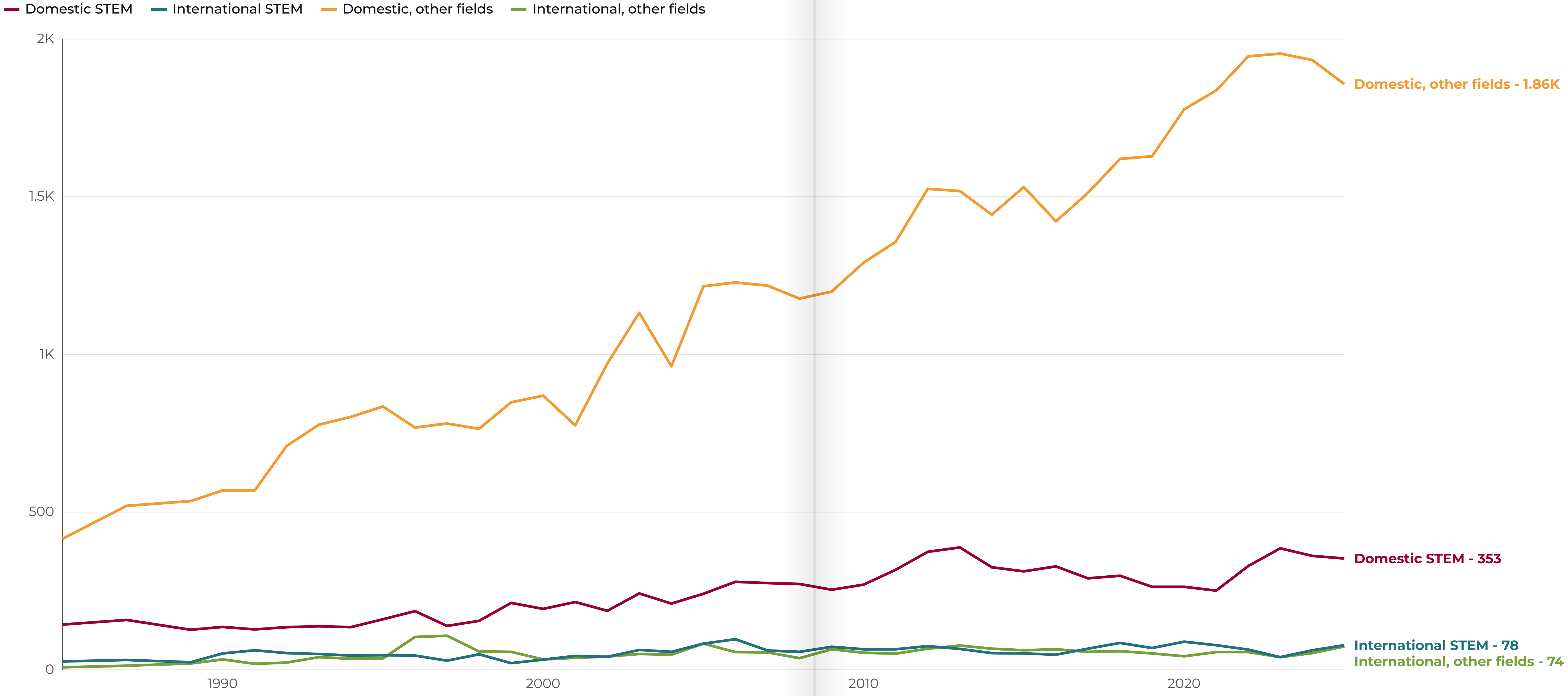
· **44th** of 51 · 0.0 pp since 2015

49%

Int. share of CS master's, 2025

U.S. **65%** · **31st** of 47 · −3.4 pp since 2020

Figure 9 Who Earns Idaho's Master's Degrees?



Master's degrees by student residency and field group. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Between 2015 and 2025, 26 more STEM master's degrees went to international students and 41 more to domestic students.

International students earn 18% of Idaho's STEM master's but 3.8% of master's in other fields (U.S. 52% and 12%).

6.4%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

U.S. **22%** · **45th** of 51 · +0.6 pp since 2015

18%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **52%** · **44th** of 51 · +3.8 pp since 2015

4.7

STEM master's per doctorate, 2025

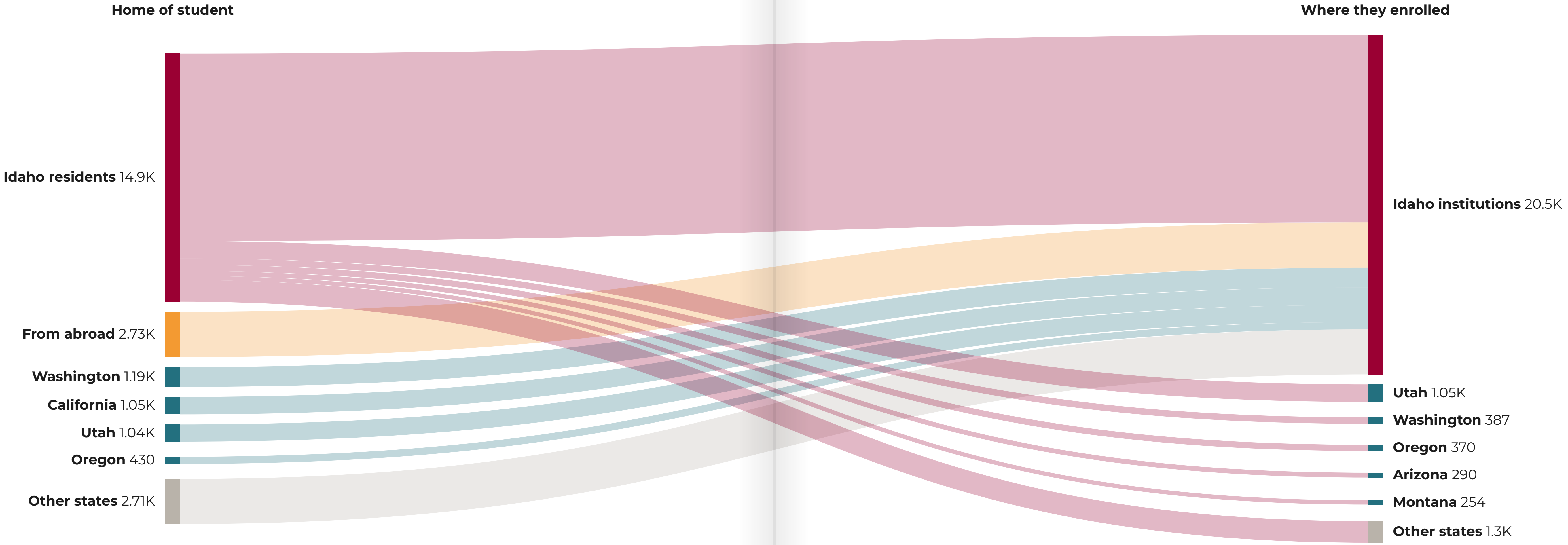
U.S. **6.4** · **34th** of 51 · +0.1 since 2015

SECTION 3

Where Students Come From

Idaho ranks 1st of 51 states on the share of first-time students whose home is outside the US, at 13% in 2024 against 3.1% for the U.S.

Figure 10 First-Time Students by Home and Destination, Fall 2024



Home of first-time degree-seeking undergraduates (left) and the state of the institution entered (right); the five largest sources and destinations, the rest grouped. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

11.3K residents stayed in Idaho for college in fall 2024; 6.43K students arrived from other states and 2.73K from abroad, while 3.66K residents left.

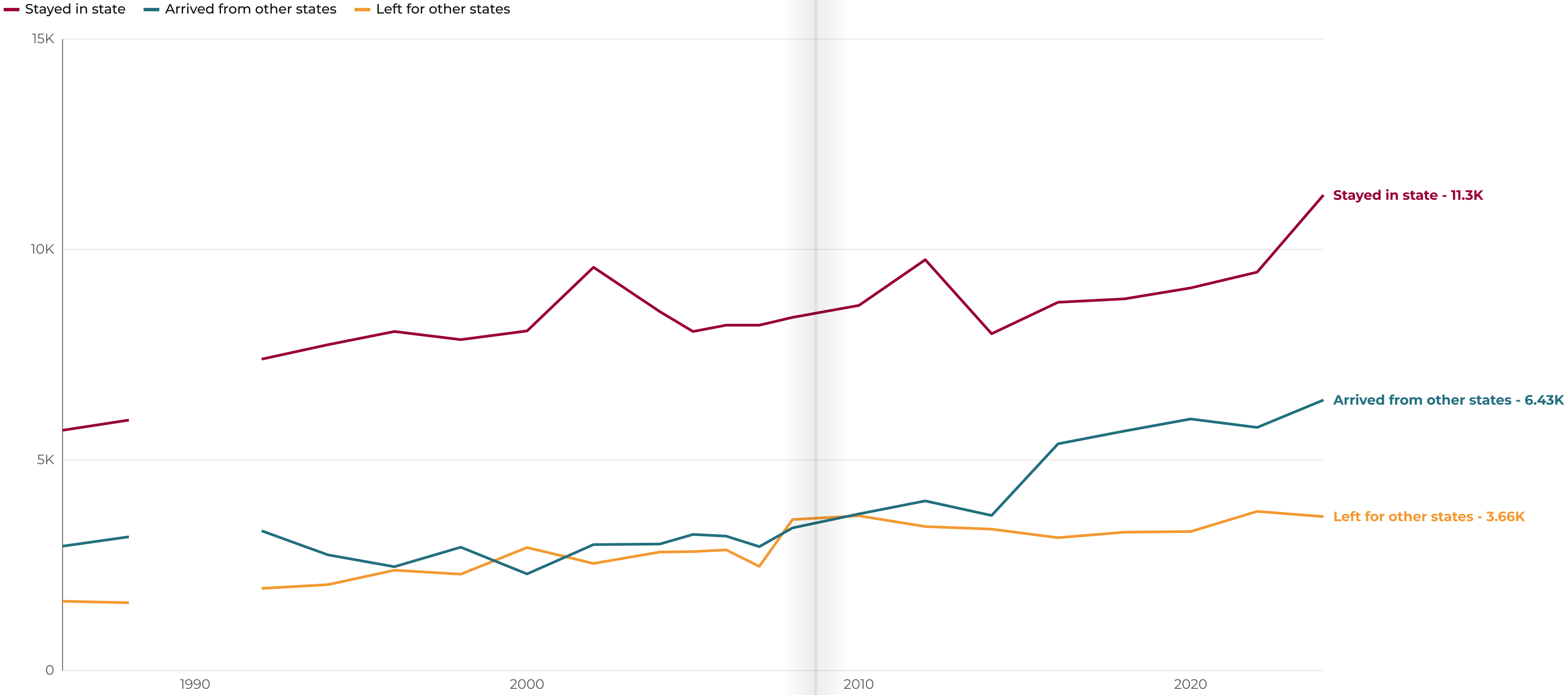
Each band runs from a student's home on the left to the state where they enrolled on the right. 54% of the state's first-time students are residents (U.S. –).

54%
First-time students from in state, 2024
· **46th** of 51 · −6.0 pp since 2016

13%
First-time students from abroad, 2024
U.S. **3.1%** · **1st** of 51 · +10.8 pp since 2016

+19
Net migration per 100 residents, 2024
· **15th** of 51 · −0.2 since 2016

Figure 11 How Have the Flows Changed?



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by flow; even years before 2001. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Since 2015, the number of residents staying in state for college is up 29%, arrivals from other states are up 19%, and residents leaving are up 16%.

Net migration was +19 per 100 resident first-time students (15th of 51). The top destination for residents who left was Utah (1.05K).

Figure 12

Where Do Idaho's Newcomers Come From?

The bands show where first-time degree-seeking undergraduates who enrolled at Idaho's institutions in fall 2024 but did not live in the state came from: the 12 largest home states and students from abroad, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Home is the state where the student lived when admitted.

Students arriving from other states. The number was 6.43K in fall 2024, up 11% from 5.77K in fall 2022 and up 19% since fall 2016, when it was 5.38K.

9.16K

First-time students from other states and abroad, fall 2024

Abroad **2.73K**

13%

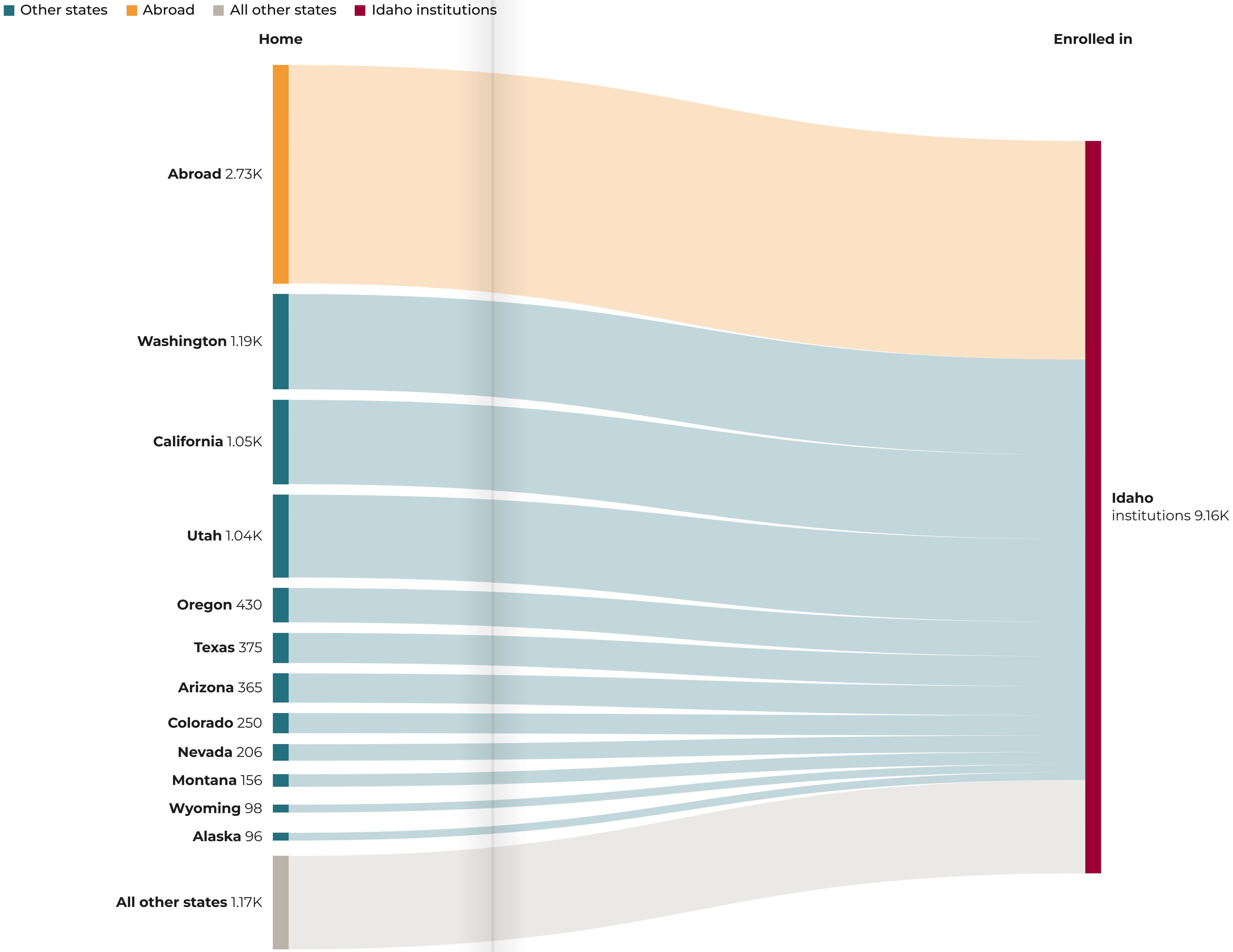
First-time students from abroad, 2024

U.S. **3.1%** · **1st** of 51 · +10.8 pp since 2016

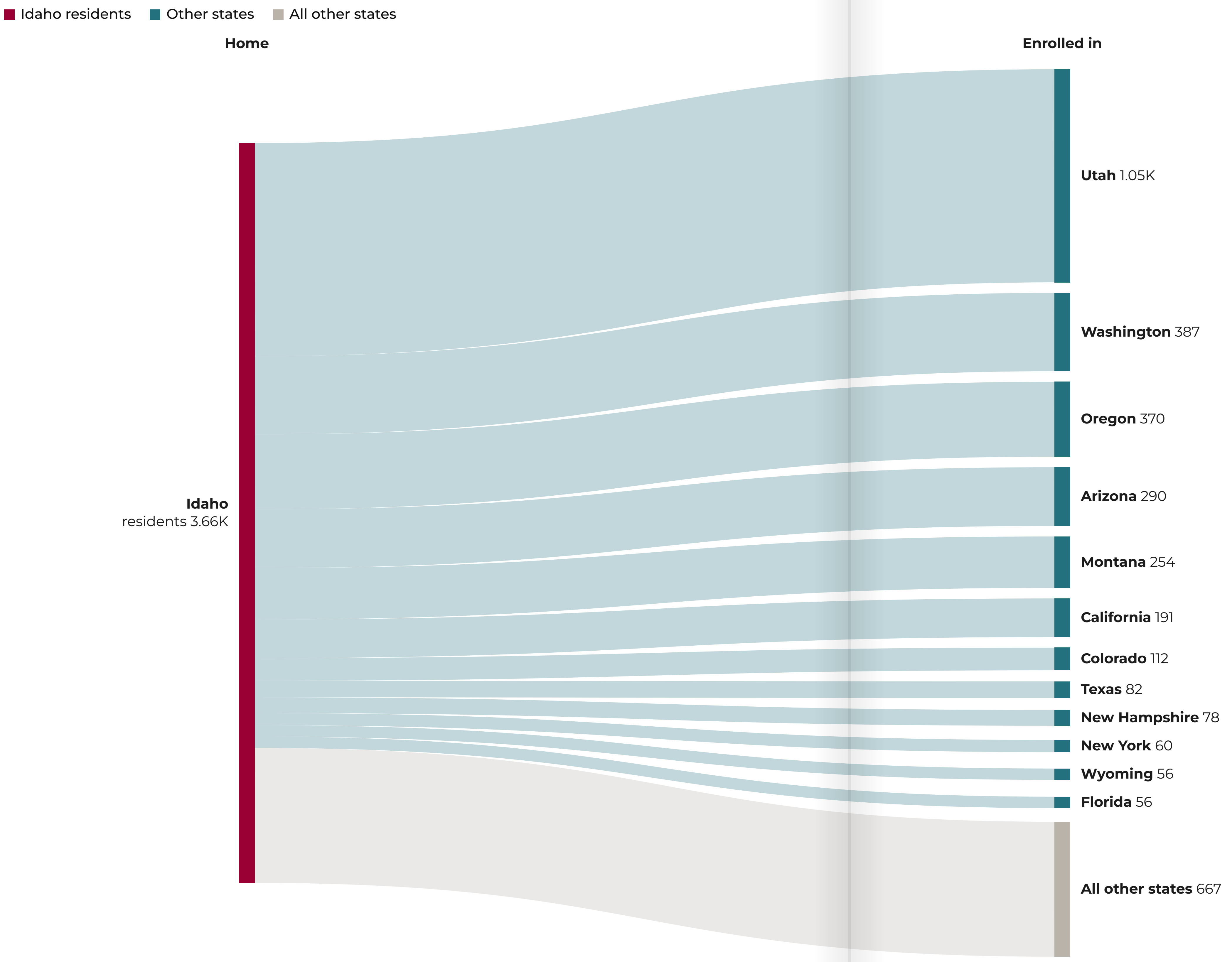
54%

First-time students from in state, 2024

46th of 51 · −6.0 pp since 2016



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Figure 13

Where Do Idaho's Residents Go When They Leave?

The bands show where Idaho residents who left the state to start college in fall 2024 enrolled: the 12 largest destination states, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Residents who enrolled in the state are not shown.

Residents leaving for other states. The number was 3.66K in fall 2024, down 3.2% from 3.78K in fall 2022 and up 16% since fall 2016, when it was 3.15K.

3.66K

Residents who started college in another state, fall 2024

Arrivals **9.16K**

+19

Net migration per 100 residents, 2024

15th of 51 · −0.2 since 2016

1.05K

Went to Utah

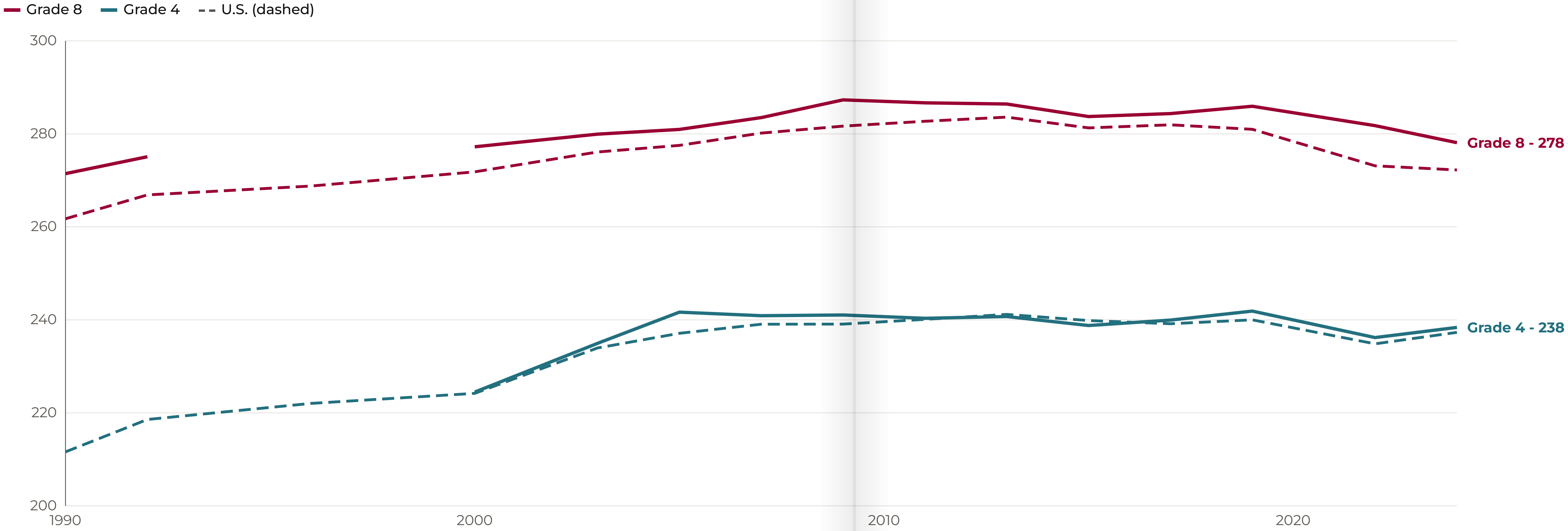
The largest destination

SECTION 4

K-12 Preparation

Idaho ranks 9th of 51 states on the average grade 8 reading score, at 261 in 2024 against 257 for the U.S.

Figure 14 How Well Prepared in Mathematics Are Idaho's Students?



Average NAEP mathematics score, public schools, 0–500 scale; state solid, U.S. public schools dashed. Data from NCES, National Assessment of Educational Progress.

The talent pipeline starts in school. Idaho's eighth graders averaged 278 in mathematics on the 2024 NAEP, against 272 for U.S. public schools, 15th of 51 among the states. 31% scored at or above the Proficient level (U.S. 27%). Differences of a point or two are often within the margin of error.

278

Grade 8 math score (NAEP), 2024

U.S. **272** · **15th** of 51 · −5.6 since 2015

31%

Grade 8 math, at or above Proficient, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **16th** of 51 · −3.1 pp since 2015

261

Grade 8 reading score (NAEP), 2024

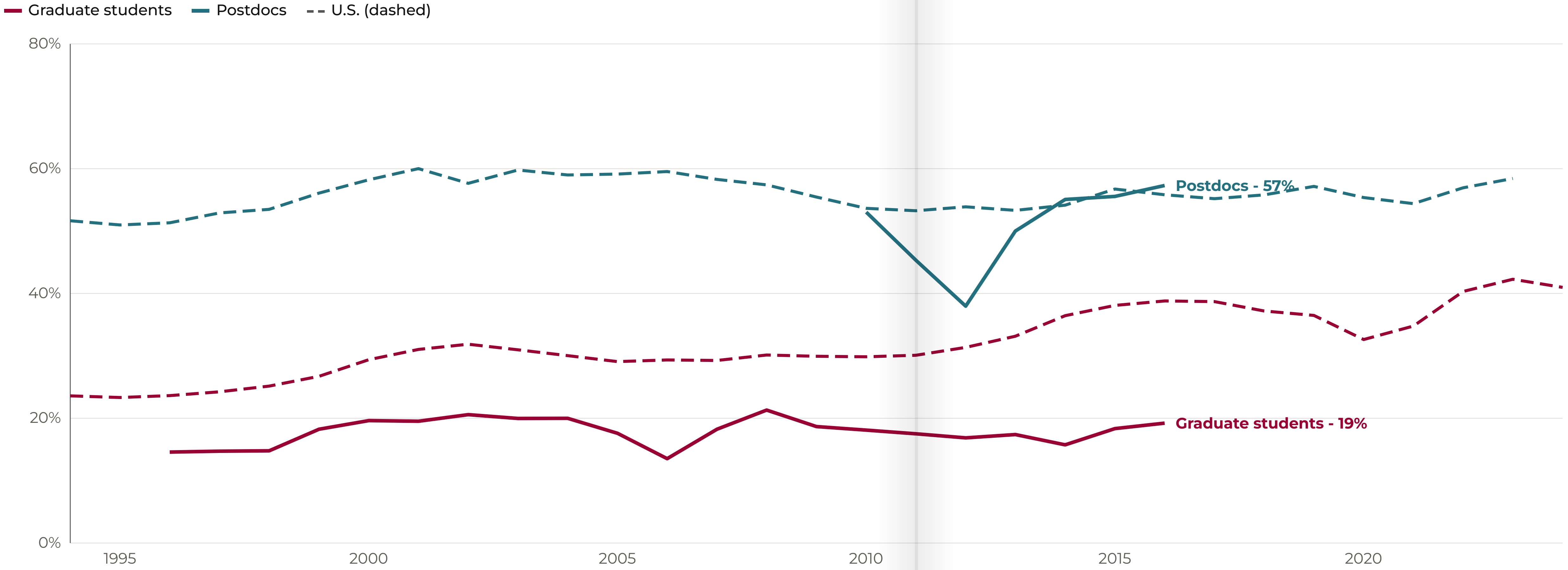
U.S. **257** · **9th** of 51 · −7.8 since 2015

SECTION 5

Graduate Research

Idaho ranks 48th of 51 states on the temporary-visa share of S&E graduate students, at 19% in 2016 against 39% for the U.S.

Figure 15 How Many of Idaho's Science and Engineering Graduate Students Hold Temporary Visas?



Temporary-visa share of science and engineering graduate students and postdoctoral appointees, by the institution's state; state solid, U.S. dashed. NSF stopped publishing state tables after 2016. Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates.

In 2016, the last year NSF published state tables, 19% of Idaho's science and engineering graduate students held temporary visas (U.S. 39%; 48th of 51).

Among postdoctoral researchers, the share was 57% (U.S. 56%). Postdocs are the stage of research training most dependent on international talent, and IPEDS does not count them.

The state's institutions awarded 145 research doctorates in 2025, 0.2% of the U.S. total (Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Earned Doctorates; NSF publishes doctorates by citizenship only for the nation).

19%

S&E grad students on temporary visas, 2016

U.S. **39%** · **48th** of 51 · +0.9 pp since 2015

57%

S&E postdocs on temporary visas, 2016

U.S. **56%** · **21st** of 51 · +1.7 pp since 2015

145

Research doctorates awarded (NSF SED), 2025

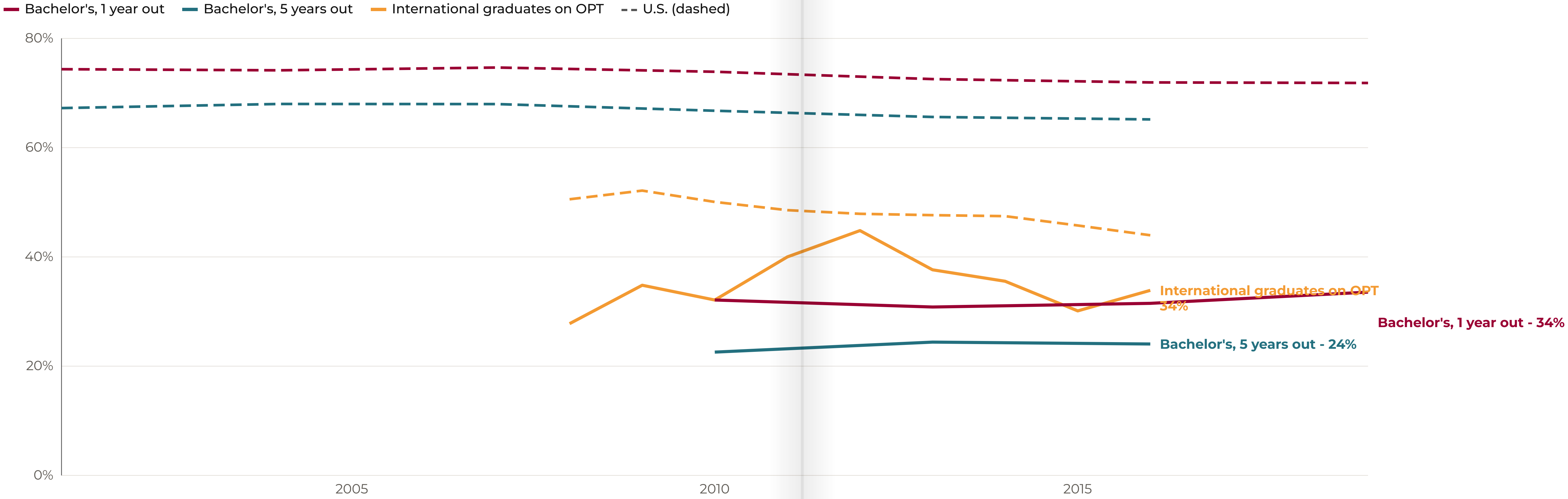
U.S. **59K** · **46th** of 51 · +26% since 2015

SECTION 6

Do Graduates Stay?

Idaho ranks 32nd of 33 states on the share of bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year after graduating, at 34% in 2019 against 72% for the U.S.

Figure 16 How Many of Idaho's Graduates Go On to Work in the State?



Share of employed graduates working in the state of their institution, by graduating cohort (Data from U.S. Census Bureau, Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes; participating institutions only); international graduates' OPT jobs in the state where they studied (Data from ICE, SEVIS FOIA releases; shares only, the file is truncated). State solid, U.S. or participating states dashed.

Of Idaho's bachelor's graduates who were working a year after graduating, 34% worked in the state (participating states 72%). Five years out the share was 24%.

Among international graduates on Optional Practical Training in 2016, 34% worked in the state where they studied (U.S. 44%). Through migration between states, the state gained 5.8 bachelor's-plus adults per 1,000 such residents in 2025 (Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey).

34%

Bachelor's grads working in-state, 1 year out, 2019

U.S. **72%** · **32nd** of 33 · +2.0 pp since 2016

34%

OPT graduates working in the state, 2016

U.S. **44%** · **28th** of 51 · +3.8 pp since 2015

+5.8

Net migration, bachelor's-plus, per 1,000, 2025

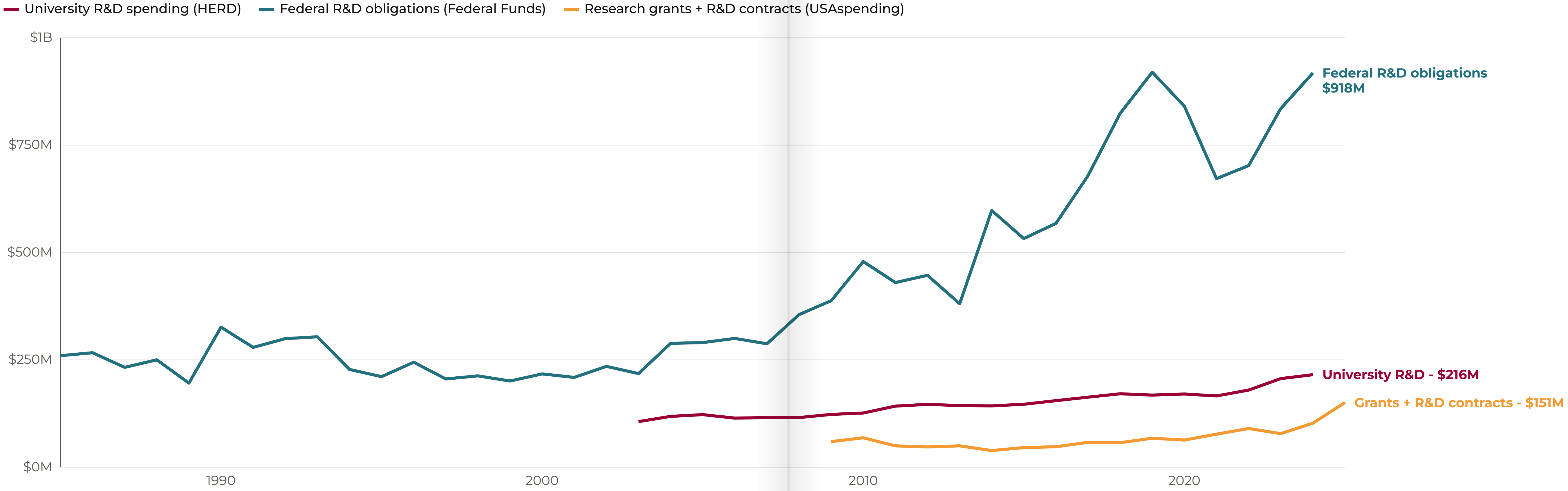
· **9th** of 51 · −2.4 since 2015

SECTION 7

Research Funding

Idaho ranks 49th of 51 states on university R&D spending, at $216M in 2024 against $118B for the U.S.

Figure 17 How Much Research Money Flows Into Idaho?



Millions of nominal dollars, fiscal years. University R&D: Data from NSF NCSES, Higher Education Research and Development Survey (FY2003-09 predecessor survey). Federal R&D obligations by state of performance: Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Federal Funds for R&D (coverage widens in FY2021). Grants from NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science plus R&D contracts: Data from USAspending.gov.

Idaho's universities spent $216M on research and development in FY2024, 49th of 51 among the states; 51% of it was federally funded (U.S. 55%).

Federal agencies obligated $918M for R&D performed in the state in FY2024. Research funding drives demand for graduate students and postdocs, the stage of training most dependent on international talent.

$216M

University R&D spending, 2024

U.S. **$118B** · **49th** of 51 · +47% since 2015

51%

Federal share of university R&D, 2024

U.S. **55%** · **32nd** of 51 · −4.3 pp since 2015

$918M

Federal R&D obligations, 2024

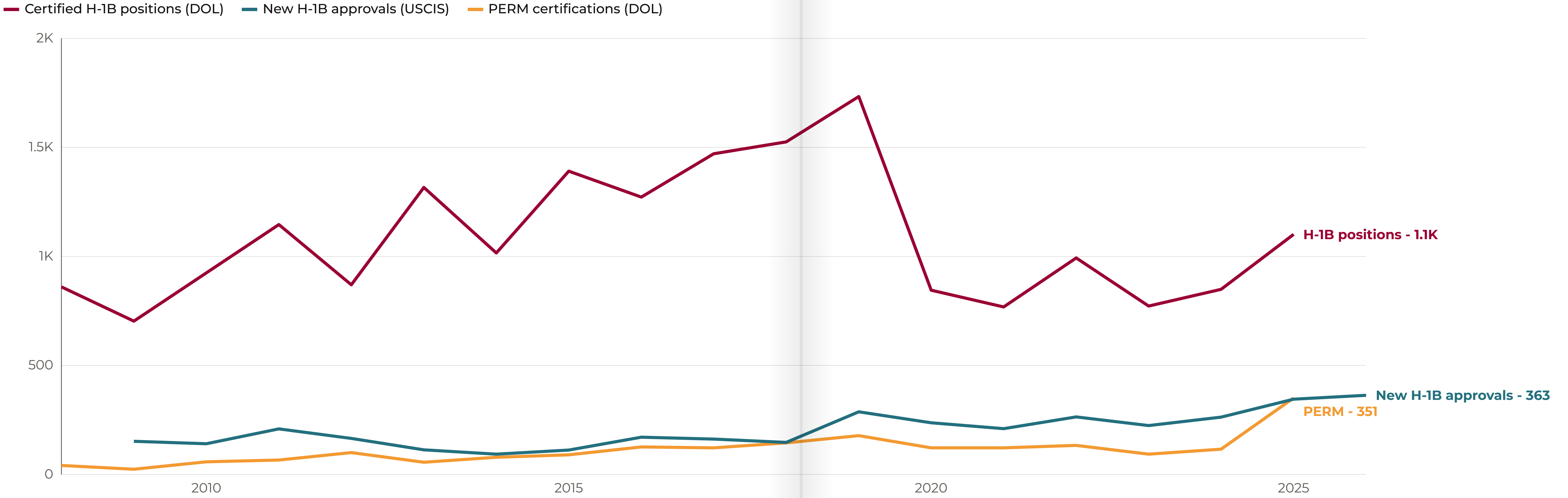
U.S. **$193B** · **30th** of 51 · +72% since 2015

SECTION 8

H-1B Jobs and Green Cards

Idaho ranks 6th of 51 states on the share of PERM certifications for workers on F-1 student visas, at 19% in 2024 against 8.7% for the U.S.

Figure 18 How Many Skilled-Visa Jobs and Green-Card Certifications Does Idaho Generate?



Certified H-1B positions on labor condition applications by worksite and certified PERM green-card applications, by fiscal year (Data from DOL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification); new H-1B petition approvals by the employer's address (Data from USCIS, H-1B Employer Data Hub).

Employers were certified for 1.1K H-1B positions at Idaho worksites in FY2025, 41st of 51 among the states. A labor certification comes before the petition, so this overstates hires; USCIS approved 363 new H-1B petitions from employers in the state in FY2026.

DOL certified 351 PERM applications, the employer's step toward an employment-based green card, for jobs in the state in FY2025. In FY2024, 19% were for workers still on F-1 student visas (U.S. 8.7%): the most direct link from classroom to permanent residence.

1.1K

Certified H-1B positions (worksite), 2025

U.S. **914K** · **41st** of 51 · −21% since 2015

351

PERM green-card certifications, 2025

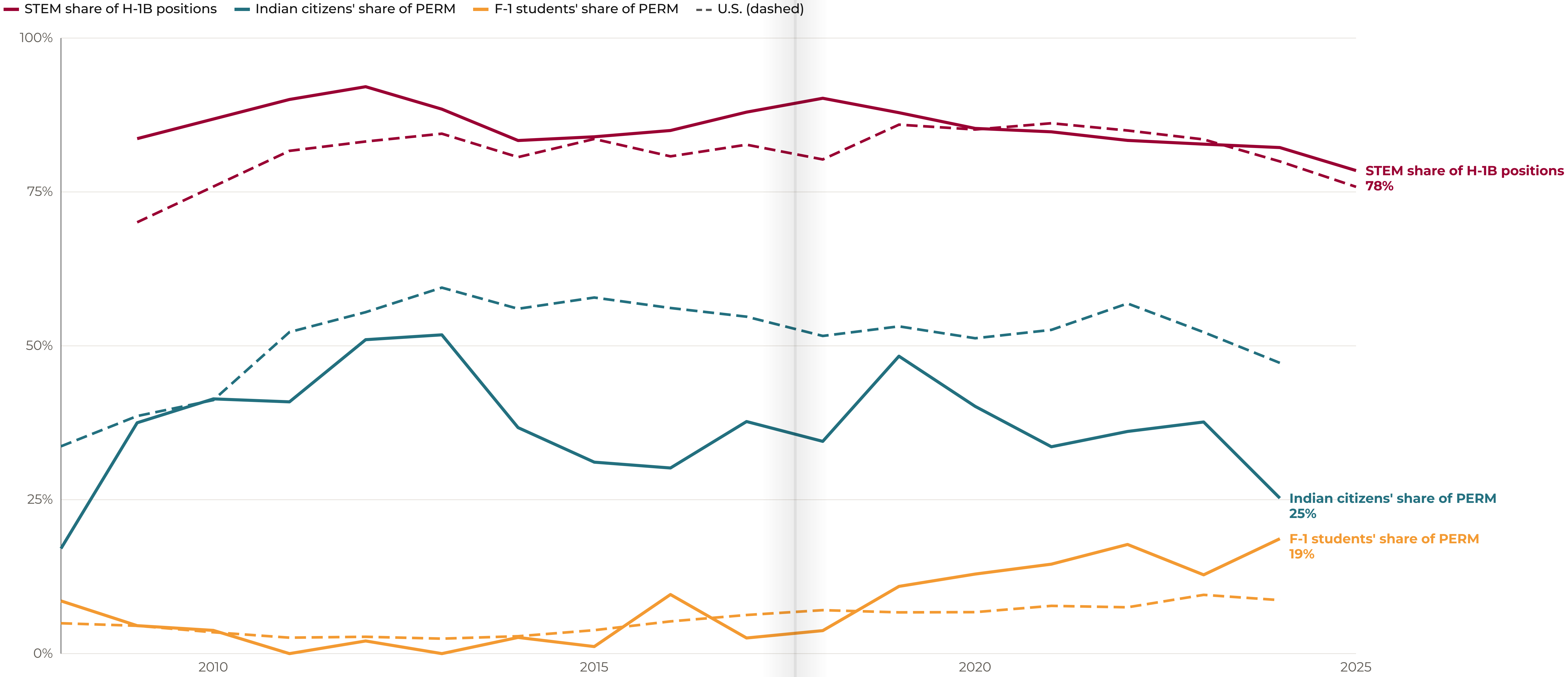
U.S. **138K** · **39th** of 51 · 3.90× since 2015

19%

PERM workers on F-1 student visas, 2024

U.S. **8.7%** · **6th** of 51 · +17.5 pp since 2015

Figure 19 Who Holds Idaho's Skilled-Visa Jobs?



State solid, U.S. dashed. PERM citizenship and class of admission are not on the form DOL uses from FY2025. Data from DOL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification.

78% of the state's certified H-1B positions were in STEM occupations in FY2025 (U.S. 76%).

Citizens of India held 25% of the state's PERM certifications in FY2024 (U.S. 47%). Under per-country caps they face the longest waits for a green card, so this share measures the state's exposure to the backlog.

78%
STEM share of H-1B positions, 2025
U.S. **76%** · **14th** of 51 · −5.5 pp since 2015

25%
PERM certifications for Indian citizens, 2024
U.S. **47%** · **36th** of 51 · −5.8 pp since 2015

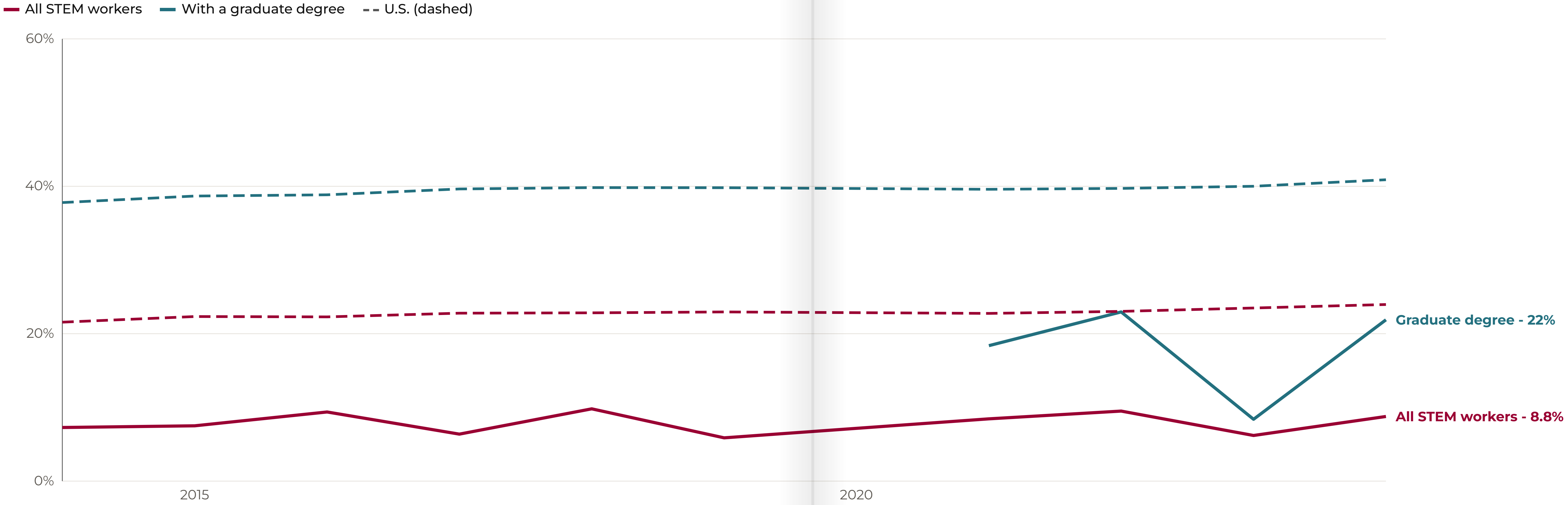
$104K
Median offered H-1B wage (nominal), 2025
U.S. **$119K** · **23rd** of 51 · +49% since 2015

SECTION 9

STEM Workforce

Idaho ranks 42nd of 51 states on the foreign-born share of STEM workers, at 8.8% in 2024 against 24% for the U.S.

Figure 20 How Much of Idaho's STEM Workforce Was Born Abroad?



Foreign-born share of employed workers in STEM occupations, by state of residence; state solid, U.S. dashed. Shares resting on fewer than 100 survey records are left out. No 2020 (experimental data). Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey.

In 2024, 8.8% of the people working in STEM occupations in Idaho were born abroad (U.S. 24%; 42nd of 51).

The share rises with education: 22% of STEM workers with a graduate degree were foreign-born (U.S. 41%). 5.3% of all STEM workers were not U.S. citizens.

8.8%

Foreign-born share of STEM workers, 2024

U.S. **24%** · **42nd** of 51 · +1.3 pp since 2015

22%

Foreign-born, STEM workers with grad degrees, 2024

U.S. **41%** · **34th** of 44 · +3.5 pp since 2021

5.3%

Noncitizen share of STEM workers, 2024

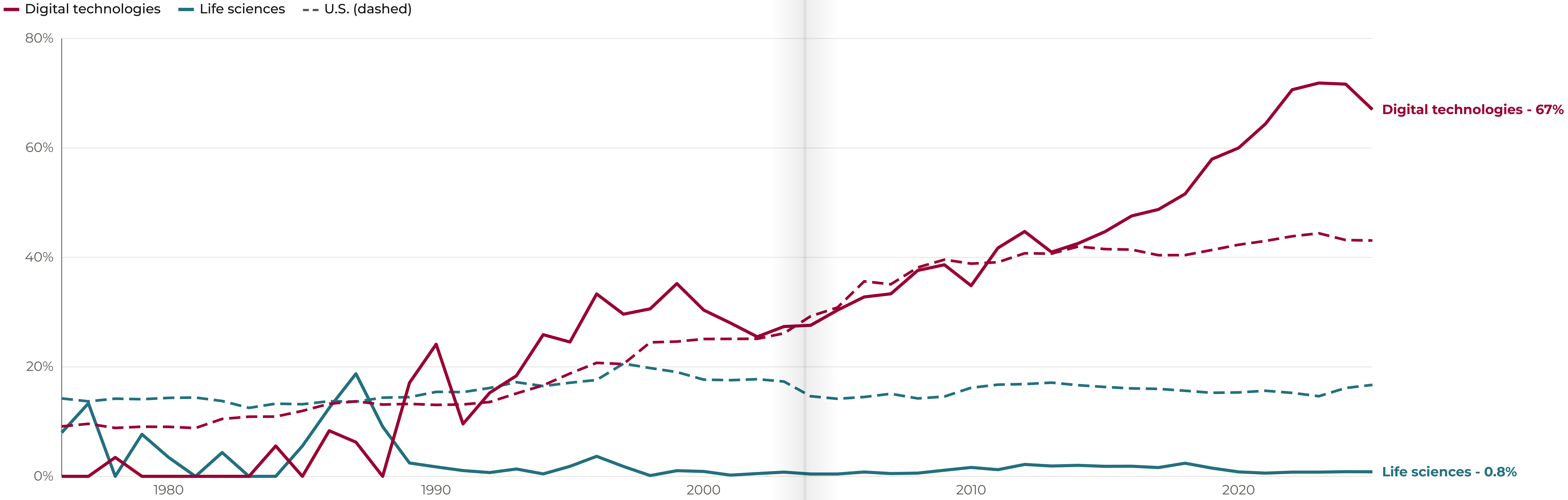
U.S. **11%** · **38th** of 51 · 0.0 pp since 2015

SECTION 10

Patents

Idaho ranks 51st of 51 states on the share of the state's patents in life sciences, at 0.8% in 2025 against 17% for the U.S.

Figure 21 **What Kinds of Technology Does Idaho Patent?**



Share of patents granted to owners in the state, by WIPO technology field of the first classification; state solid, U.S. dashed. Fractional counts by the owner's (assignee's) location, not where inventors live. Data from USPTO, PatentsView.

Organizations and people in Idaho were granted 1.56K U.S. patents in 2025, 1.2% of all patents with a U.S. owner (21st of 51).

67% were in digital technologies (U.S. 43%) and 0.8% in the life sciences (U.S. 17%).

1.56K

Patents granted to owners in the state, 2025

U.S. **135K** · **21st** of 51 · +43% since 2015

67%

Patents in digital technologies, 2025

U.S. **43%** · **3rd** of 51 · +22.3 pp since 2015

0.8%

Patents in life sciences, 2025

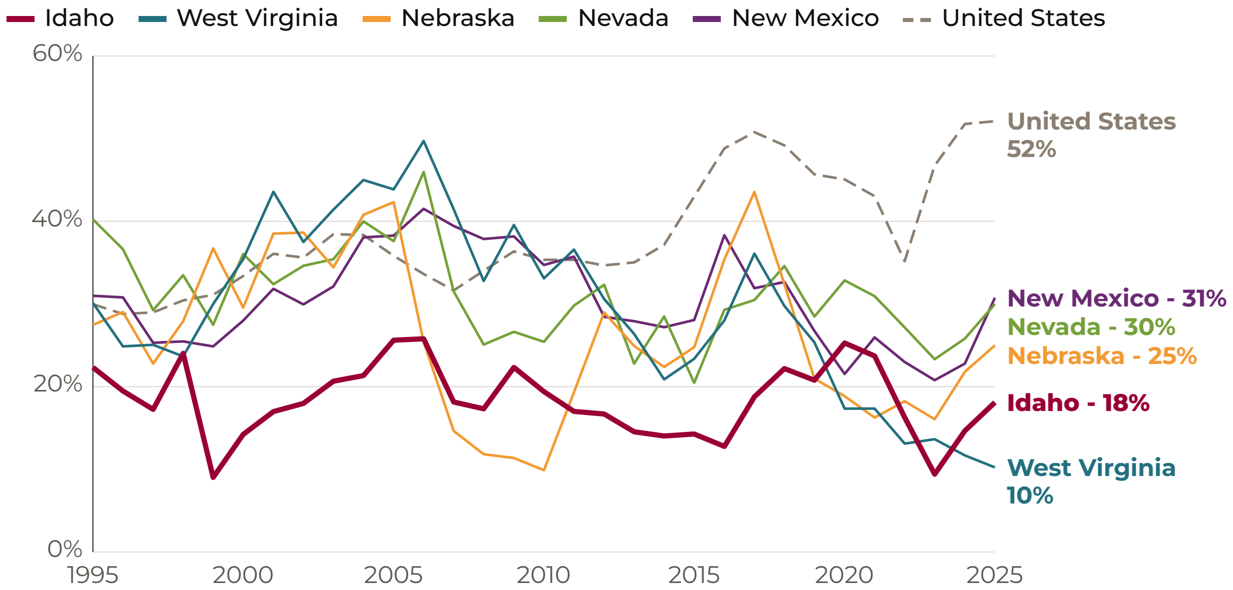
U.S. **17%** · **51st** of 51 · −1.0 pp since 2015

SECTION 11

Competitors

The four states closest in size are West Virginia, Nebraska, Nevada, New Mexico. Idaho ranks 4th of the five on the international share of STEM master's; New Mexico is the most dependent at 31%.

Figure 22 How Dependent Are Idaho and Its Peers on International STEM Master's?



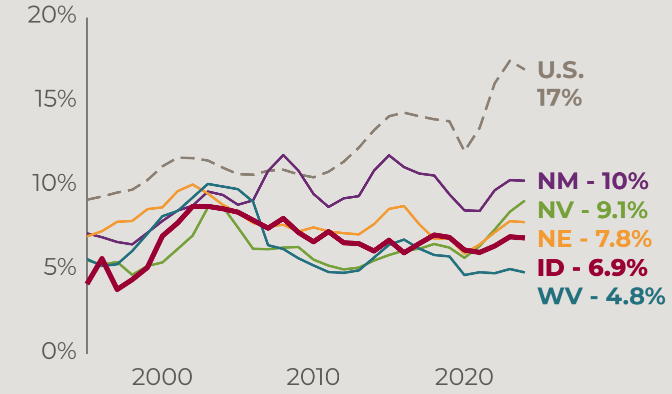
Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Table 4 How Does Idaho Compare With States of Similar Size?

Measure	ID	WV	NE	NV	NM	U.S.
Students enrolled	**136K**	137K	140K	121K	114K	19.7M
Graduate share of students	**7.0%**	16%	18%	10%	13%	17%
STEM share of bachelor's	**22%**	16%	20%	20%	22%	24%
STEM share of master's	**18%**	10%	13%	15%	24%	23%
International STEM master's	**78**	76	170	117	237	117K
Share of U.S. international STEM master's	**0.1%**	0.1%	0.1%	0.1%	0.2%	–
Int. share of STEM master's	**18%**	10%	25%	30%	31%	52%
Int. share of STEM research doctorates	**32%**	43%	38%	48%	34%	43%
Int. share of grad students	**6.9%**	4.8%	7.8%	9.1%	10%	17%
Int. share of undergraduate enrollment	**2.1%**	1.7%	2.1%	0.8%	1.7%	3.0%
Six-year graduation rate	**53%**	53%	61%	54%	50%	65%
In-state tuition, public 4-year	**$8.18K**	$9.14K	$9.29K	$6.6K	$7.98K	$9.71K
Appropriations per student	**$11K**	$10.3K	$14.2K	$10.8K	$23K	$11.4K
Average faculty salary	**$81.4K**	$76.4K	$88.5K	$110K	$84.6K	$106K
First-time students from in state	**54%**	58%	77%	91%	85%	–
Net migration per 100 residents	**+19**	+36	+2	-18	-5	–

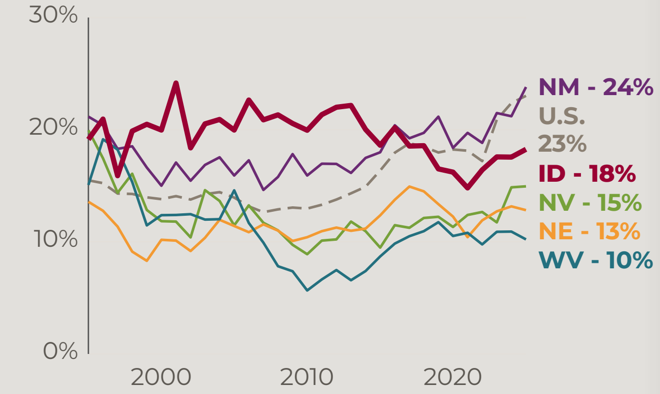
Latest year for each measure. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 23 Int. share of grad students



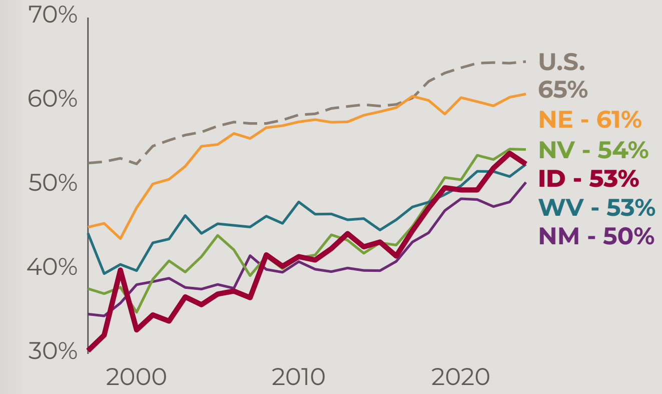
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 24 STEM share of master's



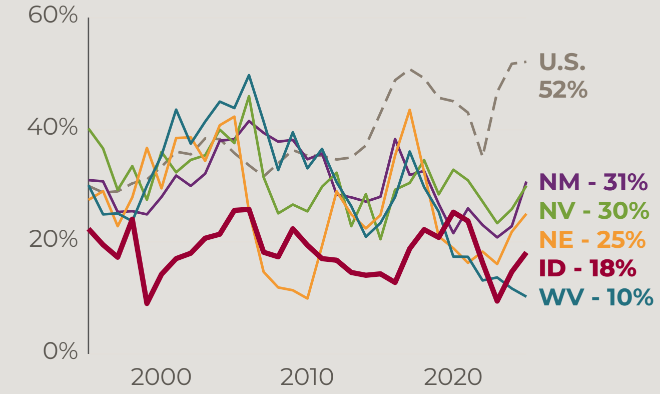
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 25 Six-year graduation rate



Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 26 Int. share of STEM master's

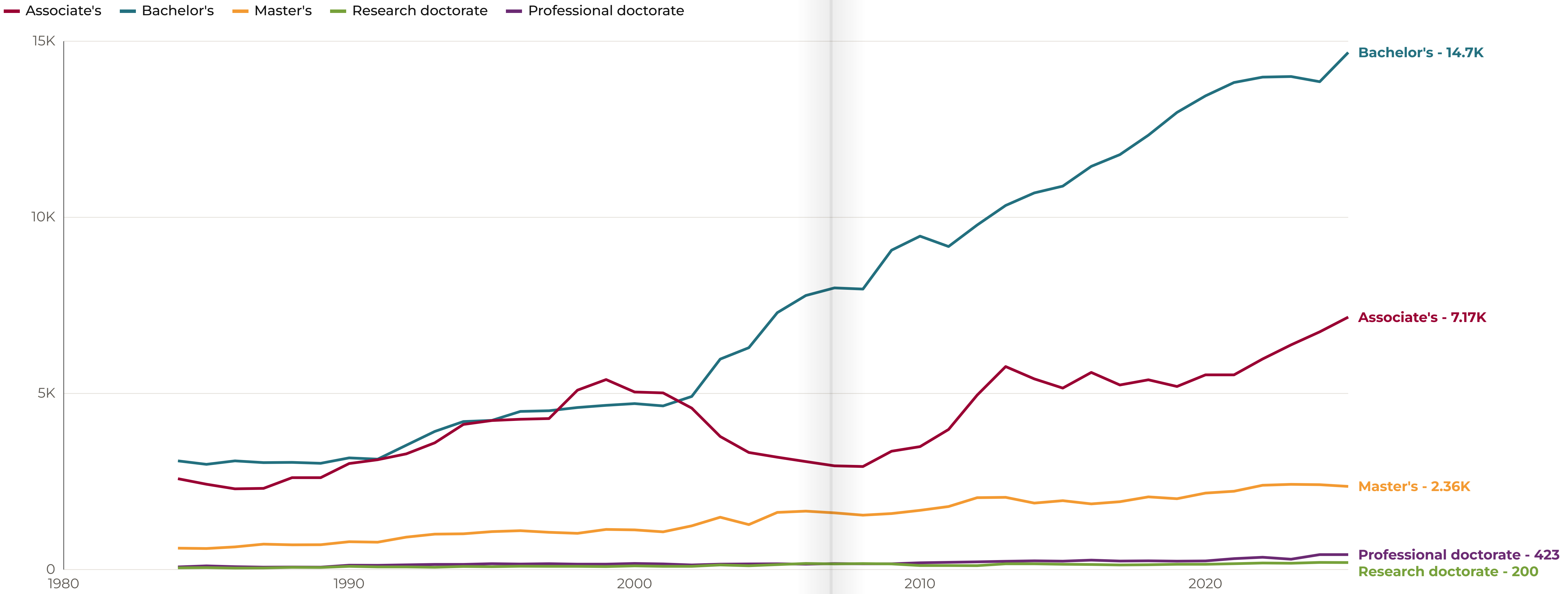


Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 12

Fields of Study

Figure 27 How Many Degrees Does Idaho Award?



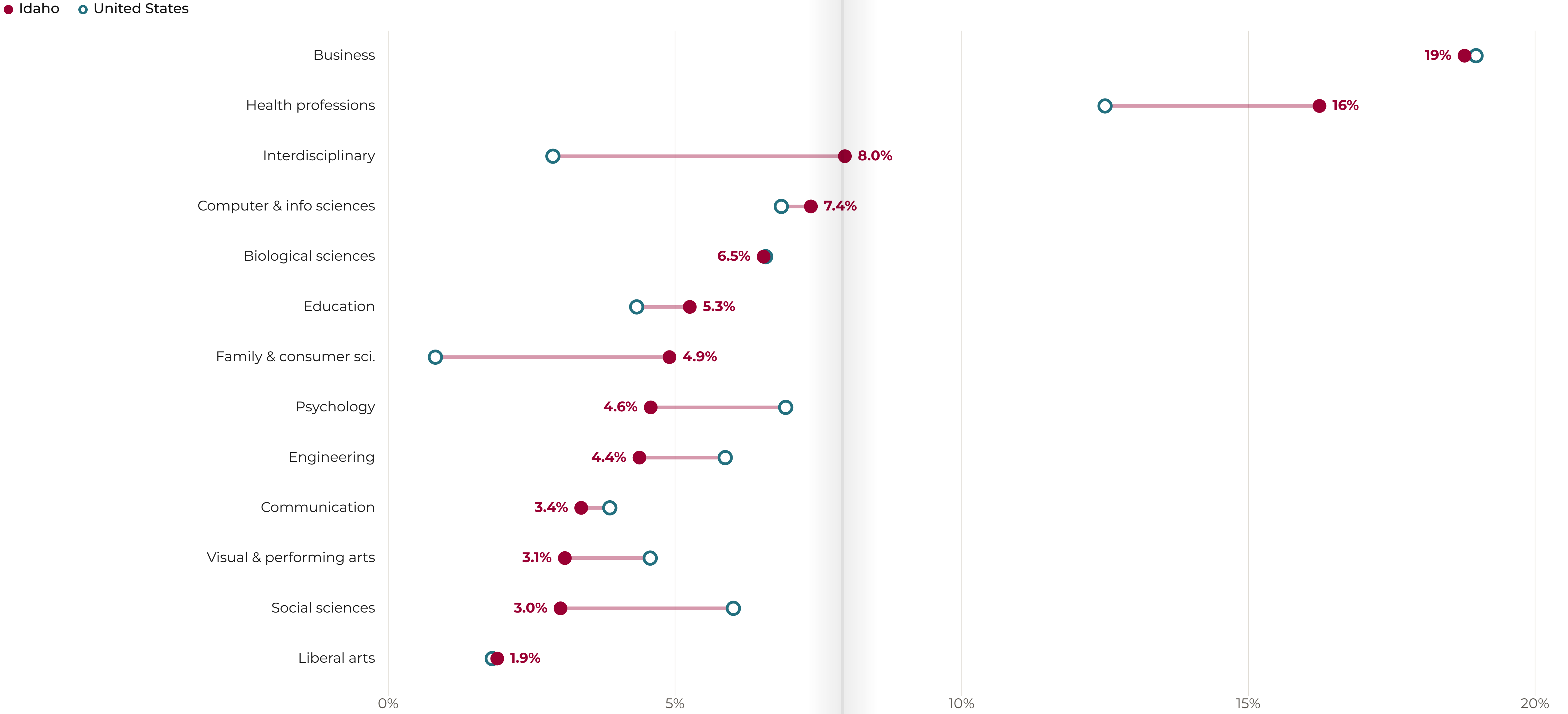
Degrees awarded by level, first majors. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

12

In 2025, Idaho's institutions awarded 7.17K associate's degrees, 14.7K bachelor's degrees, 2.36K master's degrees, 200 research doctorate degrees, 423 professional doctorate degrees.

Since 2015: associate's up 39%; bachelor's up 35%; master's up 21%; research doctorate up 33%; professional doctorate up 78%. The state awards 11.6 bachelor's degrees for every 100 undergraduates (U.S. 12.3).

Figure 28 What Do Idaho's Bachelor's Graduates Study?



Share of bachelor's degrees by field, 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Idaho's largest bachelor's fields are business (19%; U.S. 19%), health professions (16%; U.S. 13%), interdisciplinary (8.0%; U.S. 2.9%).

Relative to the nation, Idaho's bachelor's degrees are most concentrated in family & consumer sci. (5.97× the U.S. share), interdisciplinary (2.77× the U.S. share), agriculture (1.63× the U.S. share).

7.4%

Bachelor's in computer science, 2025

U.S. **6.9%** · **14th** of 51 · +4.2 pp since 2015

5.2%

Bachelor's in engineering, 2025

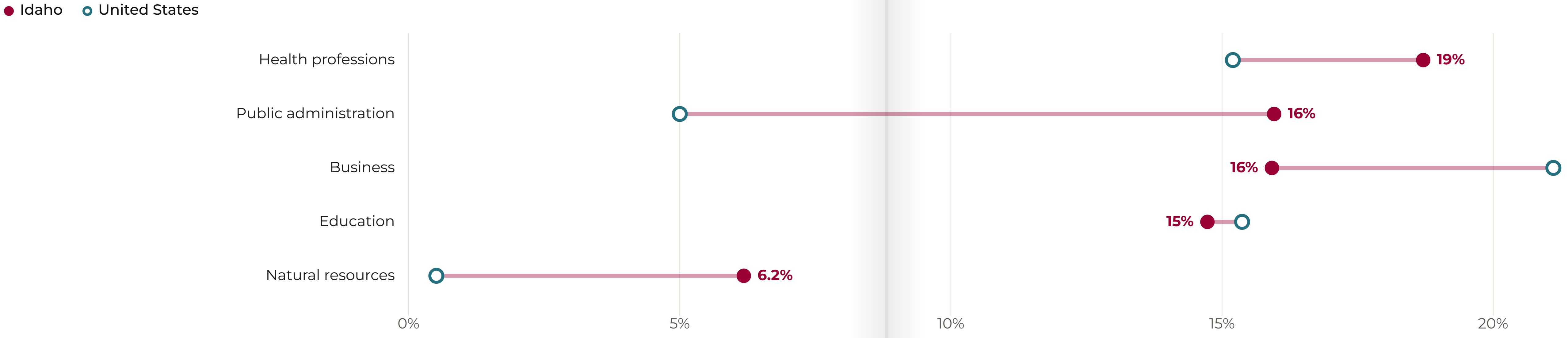
U.S. **6.8%** · **38th** of 51 · −0.1 pp since 2015

19%

Bachelor's in business, 2025

U.S. **19%** · **29th** of 51 · +3.4 pp since 2015

Figure 29 What Do Idaho's Master's Graduates Study?



Share of master's degrees by field, 2025; largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Idaho's largest master's fields are health professions (19%; U.S. 15%), public administration (16%; U.S. 5.0%), business (16%; U.S. 21%).

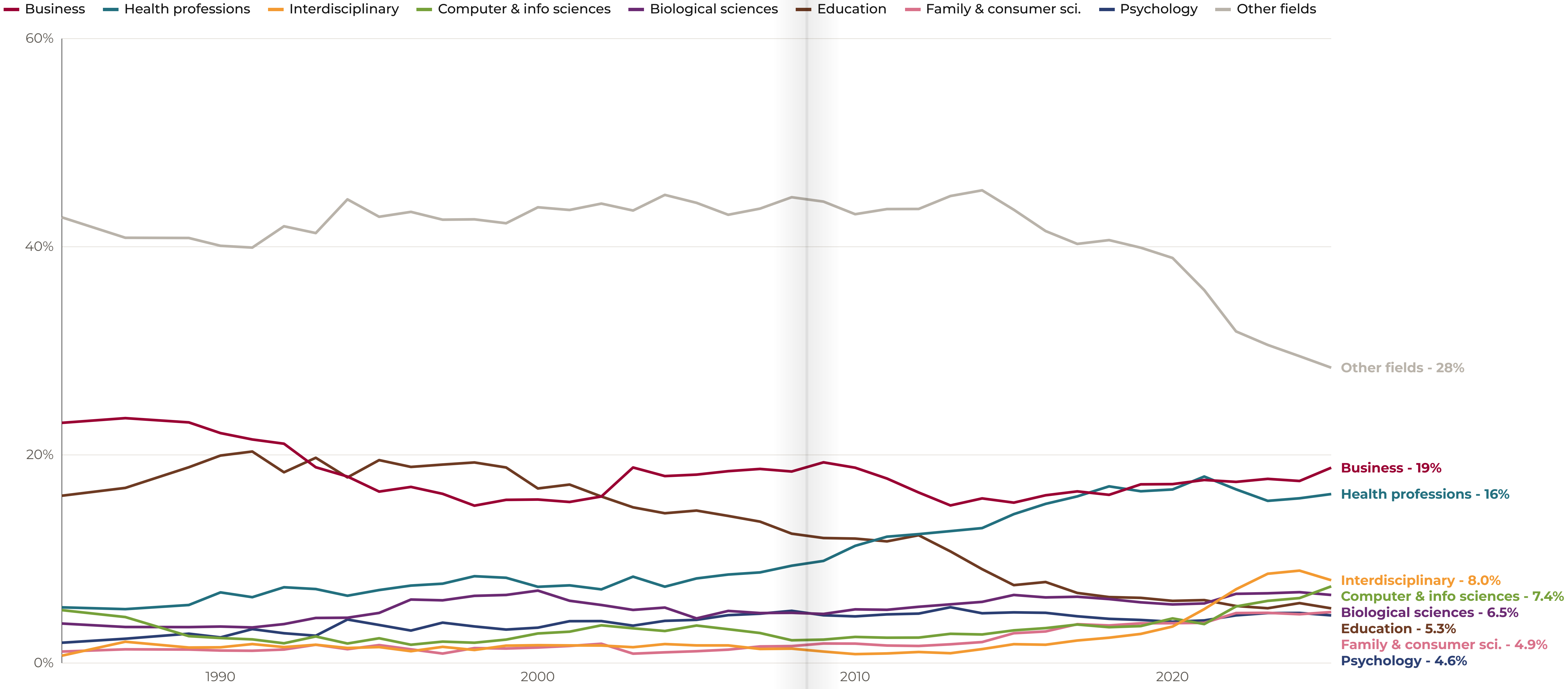
International students earn 6.4% of all master's degrees in the state (U.S. 22%), and STEM fields account for 18% of them.

18%
STEM share of master's, 2025
U.S. **23%** · **31st** of 51 · −0.4 pp since 2015

6.4%
Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **45th** of 51 · +0.6 pp since 2015

49%
Int. share of CS master's, 2025
U.S. **65%** · **31st** of 47 · −3.4 pp since 2020

Figure 30 How Has Idaho's Bachelor's Field Mix Changed?



Share of bachelor's degrees in the largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Since 2015, interdisciplinary has gained the most ground, 6.2 points of the state's bachelor's degrees, while education lost the most (2.2 points).

The chart follows the share of bachelor's degrees in each of the state's largest fields; smaller fields are grouped as other fields.

SECTION 12 · FIELDS OF STUDY

Where Is Idaho Most Specialized?

The location quotient divides a field's share of Idaho's bachelor's degrees by its share of all U.S. bachelor's degrees in 2025. A quotient of 1.00 means the same share as the nation; 2.00 means twice the national share. The table lists the 10 fields with the highest quotients among fields with at least 50 degrees.

Highest location quotients. Family & consumer sci. (5.97, with 4.9% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 0.8% for the U.S.), interdisciplinary (2.77, with 8.0% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 2.9% for the U.S.), and agriculture (1.63, with 1.7% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 1.0% for the U.S.) had the highest quotients.

Table 5 Where Is Idaho Most Specialized?

Field	Location quotient	State share	U.S. share	Degrees
Family & consumer sci.	**5.97**	4.9%	0.8%	720
Interdisciplinary	**2.77**	8.0%	2.9%	1.17K
Agriculture	**1.63**	1.7%	1.0%	246
Health professions	**1.30**	16%	13%	2.38K
Education	**1.21**	5.3%	4.3%	772
Natural resources	**1.15**	1.3%	1.1%	188
Computer & info sciences	**1.08**	7.4%	6.9%	1.08K
Liberal arts	**1.05**	1.9%	1.8%	279
Public administration	**1.02**	1.5%	1.5%	220
Biological sciences	**0.99**	6.5%	6.6%	961

Bachelor's degrees; location quotient = state share ÷ U.S. share; fields with 50+ degrees. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

22%
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · **27th** of 51

7.4%
Bachelor's in computer science, 2025
U.S. **6.9%** · **14th** of 51

5.2%
Bachelor's in engineering, 2025
U.S. **6.8%** · **38th** of 51

19%
Bachelor's in business, 2025
U.S. **19%** · **29th** of 51

Engineering. The share was 5.2% in 2025, against 6.8% for the U.S., 38th among the states, up 0.4 points from 4.8% in 2024 and down 0.1 points since 2015, when it was 5.3%.

Health professions. The share was 16% in 2025, against 12% for the U.S., 10th among the states, up 0.4 points from 16% in 2024 and up 1.9 points since 2015, when it was 14%.

Table 6 Idaho at a Glance

Measure	2015	Previous	Latest	Change	U.S.	Rank
STEM share of bachelor's	19%	21% 2024	**22%** **2025**	+2.9 pp	24%	27th
Bachelor's in computer science	3.1%	6.2% 2024	**7.4%** **2025**	+4.2 pp	6.9%	14th
Bachelor's in engineering	5.3%	4.8% 2024	**5.2%** **2025**	−0.1 pp	6.8%	38th
Bachelor's in business	15%	17% 2024	**19%** **2025**	+3.4 pp	19%	29th

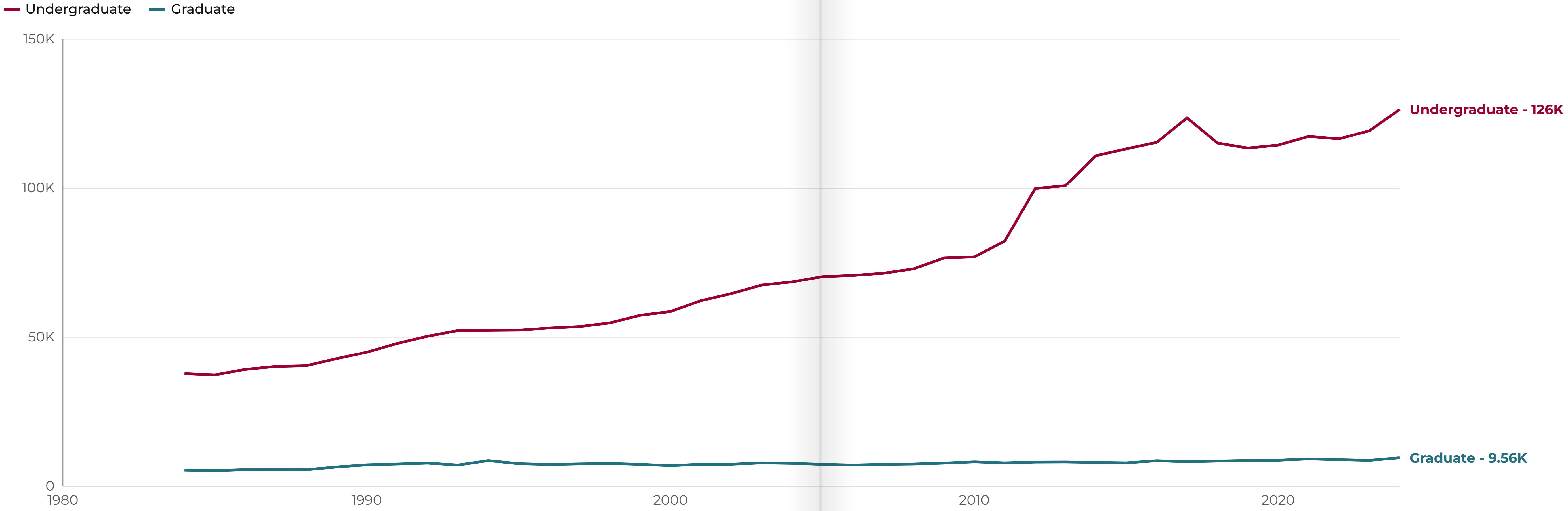
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 13

Students and Money

Idaho ranks 51st of 51 states on the share of students who are graduate students, at 7.0% in 2024 against 17% for the U.S.

Figure 31 How Has Enrollment Changed?



Fall headcount enrollment. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

In fall 2024, Idaho enrolled 126K undergraduates and 9.56K graduate students, 136K in all (38th of 51).

Undergraduate enrollment is up 12% since 2015 and graduate enrollment up 22% since 2015. Graduate students are 7.0% of all students (U.S. 17%).

136K
Students enrolled, 2024
U.S. **19.7M** · **38th** of 51 · +12% since 2015

7.0%
Graduate share of students, 2024
U.S. **17%** · **51st** of 51 · +0.5 pp since 2015

53%
Students attending part-time, 2024
U.S. **39%** · **2nd** of 51 · +3.4 pp since 2015

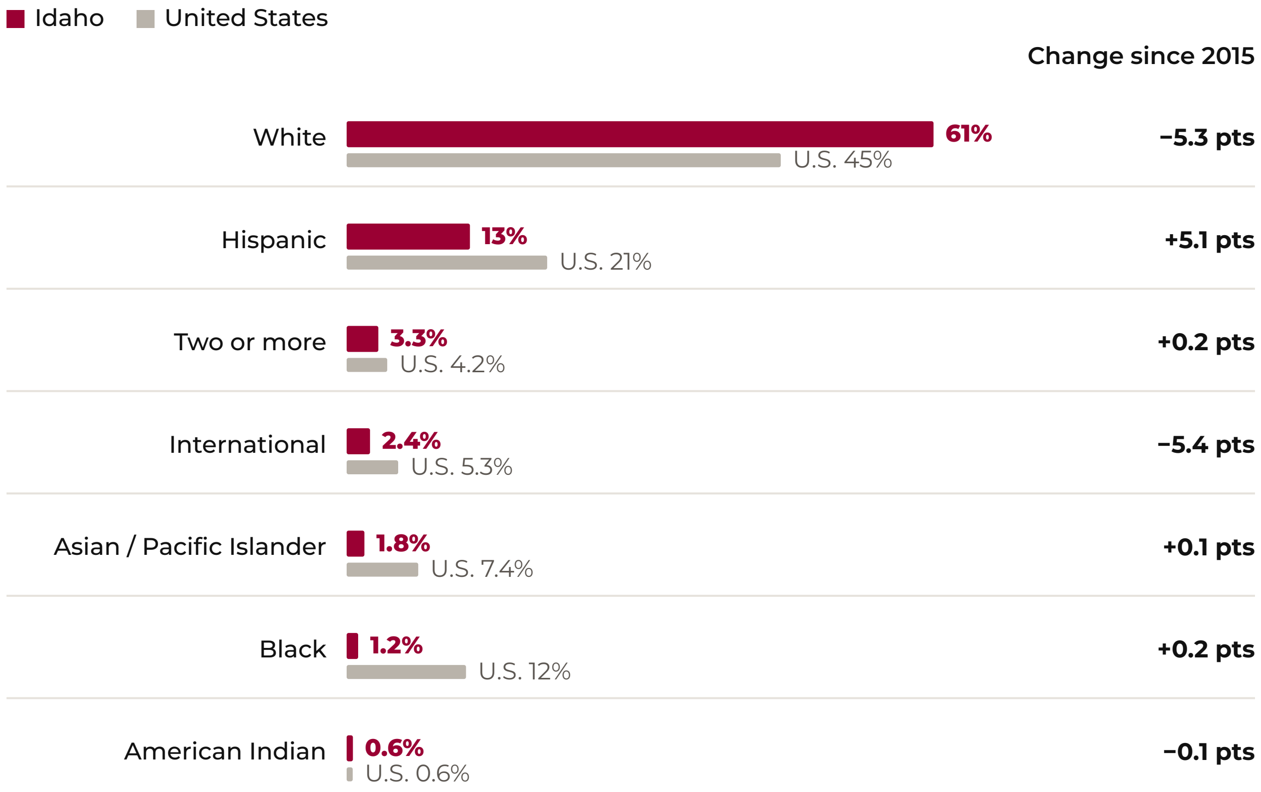
SECTION 13 · STUDENTS AND MONEY

Who Enrolls in Idaho, and Where?

In fall 2024, White students were the largest group at Idaho's degree-granting institutions, **61%** of enrollment against 45% nationally, down 5.3 points since 2015.

Hispanic students were **13%** (U.S. 21%), up 5.1 points since 2015, and students of two or more races were **3.3%** (U.S. 4.2%), up 0.2 points since 2015.

Figure 32 Who Enrolls in Idaho?



Share of fall 2024 headcount enrollment by race and ethnicity; students of unknown race are left out of the chart. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

61%
White students
U.S. **45%** · −5.3 pp since 2015

13%
Hispanic students
U.S. **21%** · +5.1 pp since 2015

49%
At public 4-year institutions
+7.5 pp since 2015

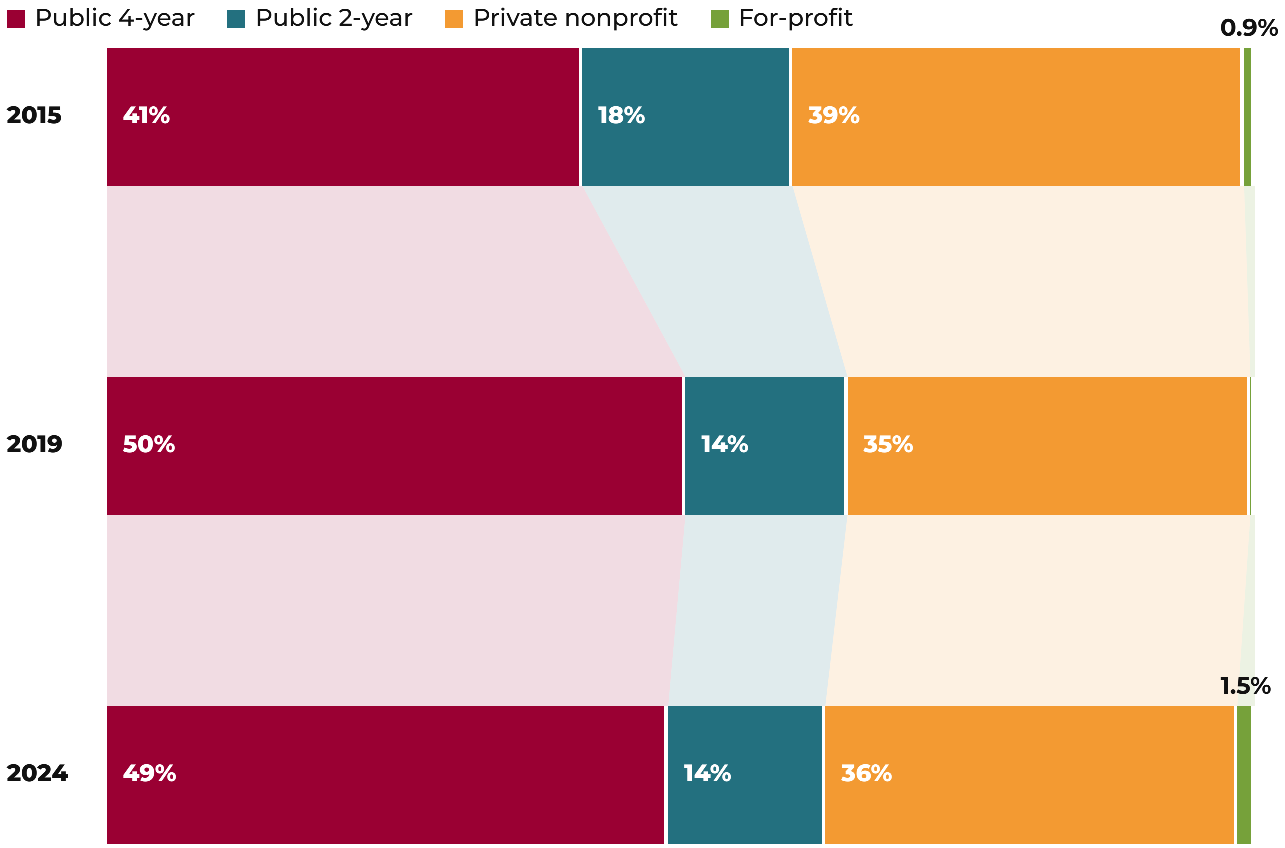
36%
At private nonprofit institutions
−3.5 pp since 2015

In fall 2024, public 4-year institutions enrolled **49%** of students, up 7.5 points from 41% in 2015. Private nonprofit institutions enrolled **36%** of students, down 3.5 points from 39% in 2015.

Public 2-year institutions enrolled **14%** of students, down 4.6 points from 18% in 2015, and for-profit institutions enrolled **1.5%** of students, up 0.6 points from 0.9% in 2015.

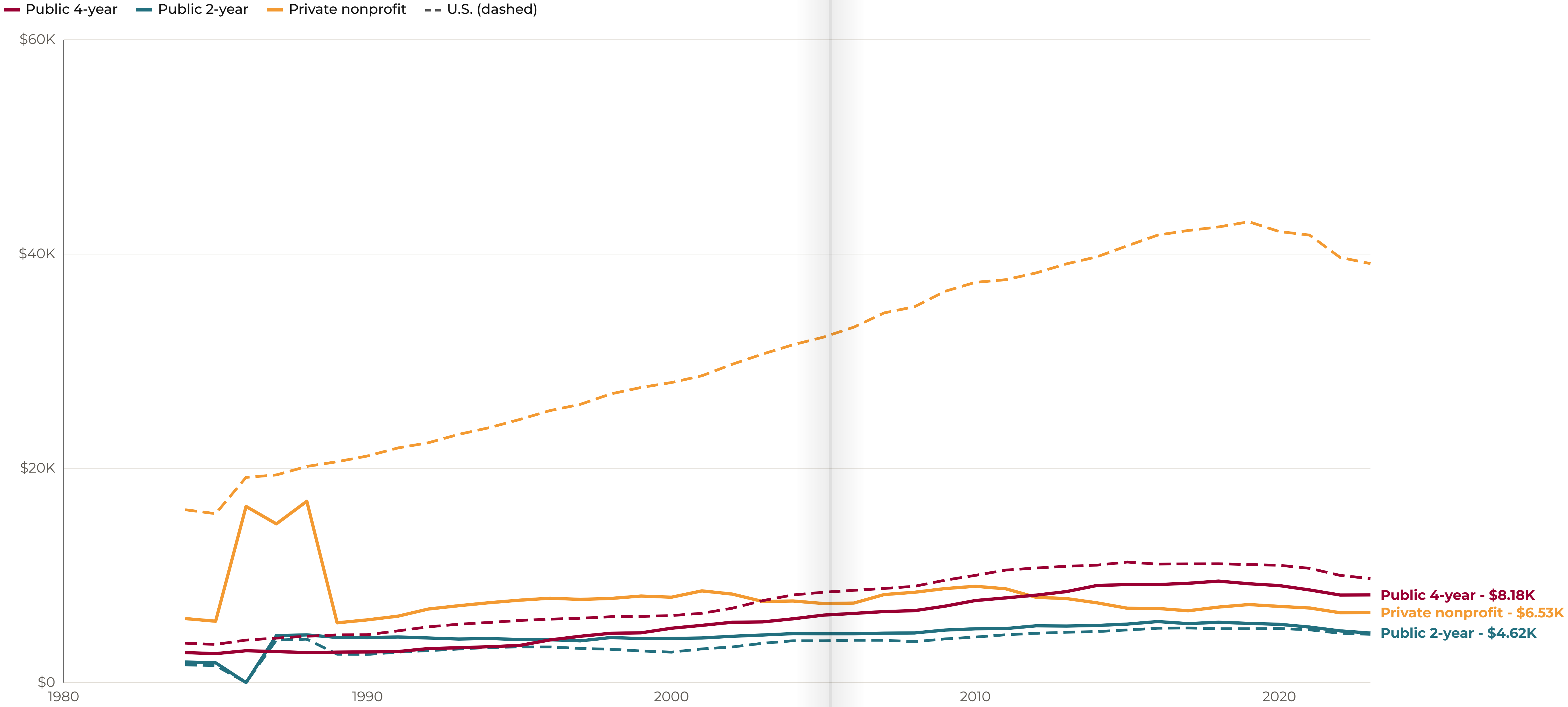
Public institutions together enrolled **63%** of students, against 73% nationally, 39th among the states.

Figure 33 Where Do Students Enroll?



Share of fall headcount enrollment by sector, 2015, 2019, 2024. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 34 What Does In-State Tuition Cost?



Published in-state tuition and fees, 2024 dollars (CPI-U); state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

In-state tuition and fees at Idaho's public four-year institutions are $8.18K (2023, 2024 dollars), 16% below the U.S. ($9.71K); the state ranks 39th of 51.

State and local appropriations come to $11K per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions (26th of 51), and tuition makes up 42% of their core revenue (U.S. 43%).

$8.18K

In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023

U.S. **$9.71K** · **39th** of 51 · −11% since 2015

$11K

Appropriations per student, 2024

U.S. **$11.4K** · **26th** of 51 · +11% since 2015

42%

Tuition share of public revenue, 2024

U.S. **43%** · **30th** of 51 · −3.8 pp since 2015

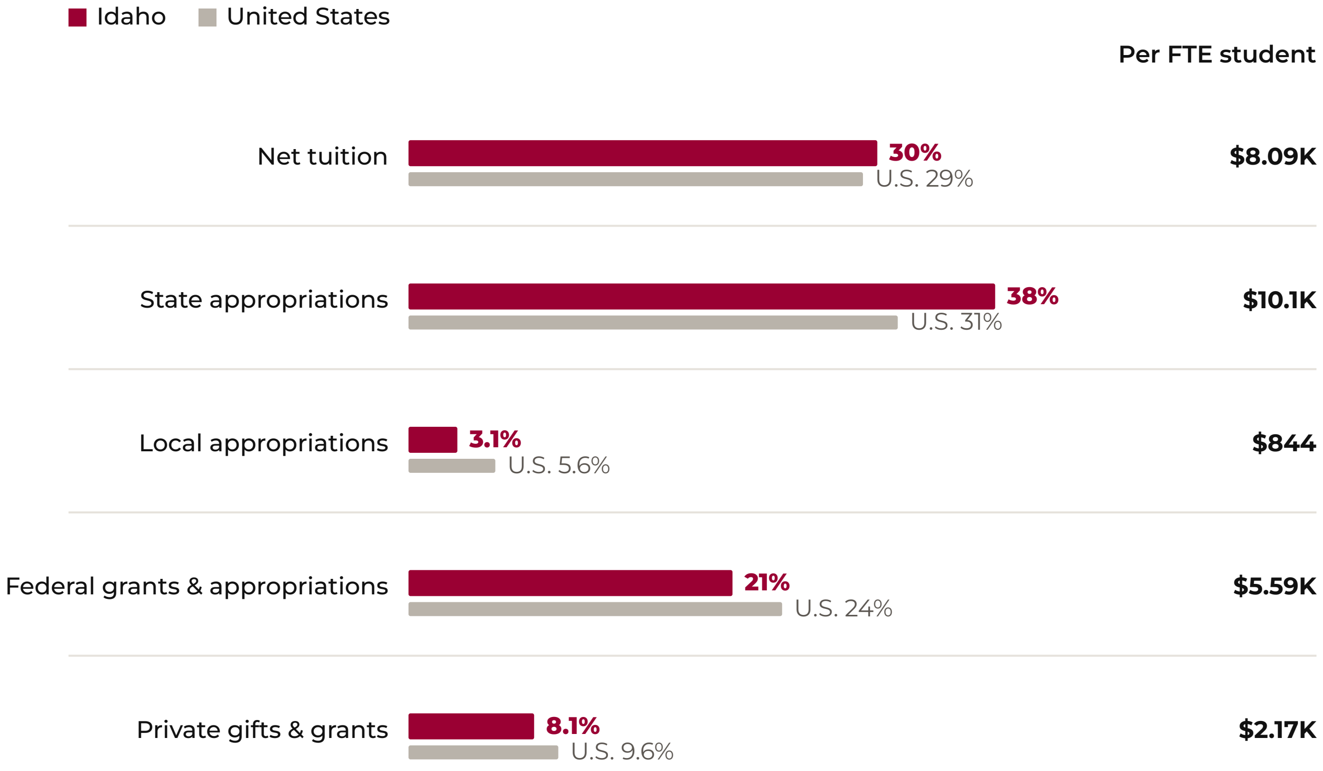
SECTION 13 · STUDENTS AND MONEY

How Are Idaho's Public Institutions Funded, and What Do They Produce?

The bars give each source's share of the core revenue of Idaho's public institutions, with the nation for comparison, and at right the dollars per full-time-equivalent (FTE) student it provides. Values are in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Net tuition is tuition and fees after institutional discounts and allowances.

Net tuition per FTE student. The figure was $8.09K in FY2024, against $8.96K for the U.S., down 5.7% from $8.58K in FY2023 and down 5.1% since FY2015, when it was $8.53K.

Figure 35 How Are Public Institutions Funded?



Share of core revenue per FTE student by source, public institutions, FY2024; dollars per FTE at right, 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS Finance.

$8.18K
In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023
U.S. **$9.71K** · **39th** of 51

$11K
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11.4K** · **26th** of 51

42%
Tuition share of public revenue, 2024
U.S. **43%** · **30th** of 51

53%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · **47th** of 51

The table brings together five measures of what public higher education costs and what it produces in Idaho: in-state tuition at public four-year institutions, state and local appropriations per full-time-equivalent student, tuition's share of public institutions' core revenue, the six-year bachelor's graduation rate, and the average full-time faculty salary.

In-state tuition, public 4-year. The figure was $8.18K in 2023, against $9.71K for the U.S., 39th among the states, up 0.2% from $8.17K in 2022 and down 11% since 2015, when it was $9.15K.

Table 7 Money and Results

Measure	Year	Idaho	U.S.	Rank	Change since 2015
In-state tuition, public 4-year	2023	**$8.18K**	$9.71K	39th of 51	−11%
Appropriations per student	2024	**$11K**	$11.4K	26th of 51	+11%
Tuition share of public revenue	2024	**42%**	43%	30th of 51	−3.8 pp
Six-year graduation rate	2024	**53%**	65%	47th of 51	+9.2 pp
Average faculty salary	2024	**$81.4K**	$106K	44th of 51	−4.6%

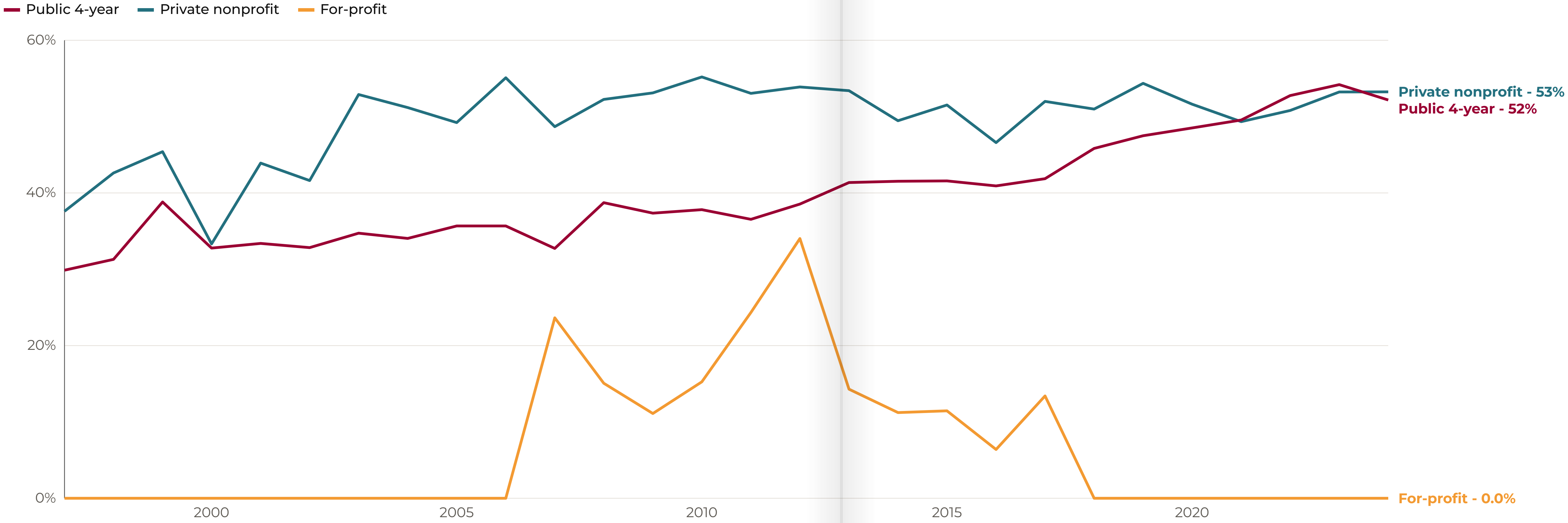
Rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Dollars in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 14

Student Outcomes

Idaho ranks 47th of 51 states on the six-year bachelor's graduation rate, 4-year institutions, at 53% in 2024 against 65% for the U.S.

Figure 36 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Sector?



Six-year bachelor's graduation rate by sector of institution. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

53% of students who started a bachelor's degree at a four-year institution in Idaho graduated within six years (2024), 12.2 points below the U.S. (65%); the state ranks 47th of 51.

By sector: public 4-year 52%, private nonprofit 53%, for-profit 0.0%. At two-year institutions, 36% complete within 150% of normal time (U.S. 41%).

53%

Six-year graduation rate, 2024

U.S. **65%** · **47th** of 51 · +9.2 pp since 2015

36%

Two-year completion rate, 2024

U.S. **41%** · **34th** of 50 · +14.5 pp since 2015

11.6

Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025

U.S. **12.3** · **39th** of 51 · +1.8 since 2015

SECTION 14 · STUDENT OUTCOMES

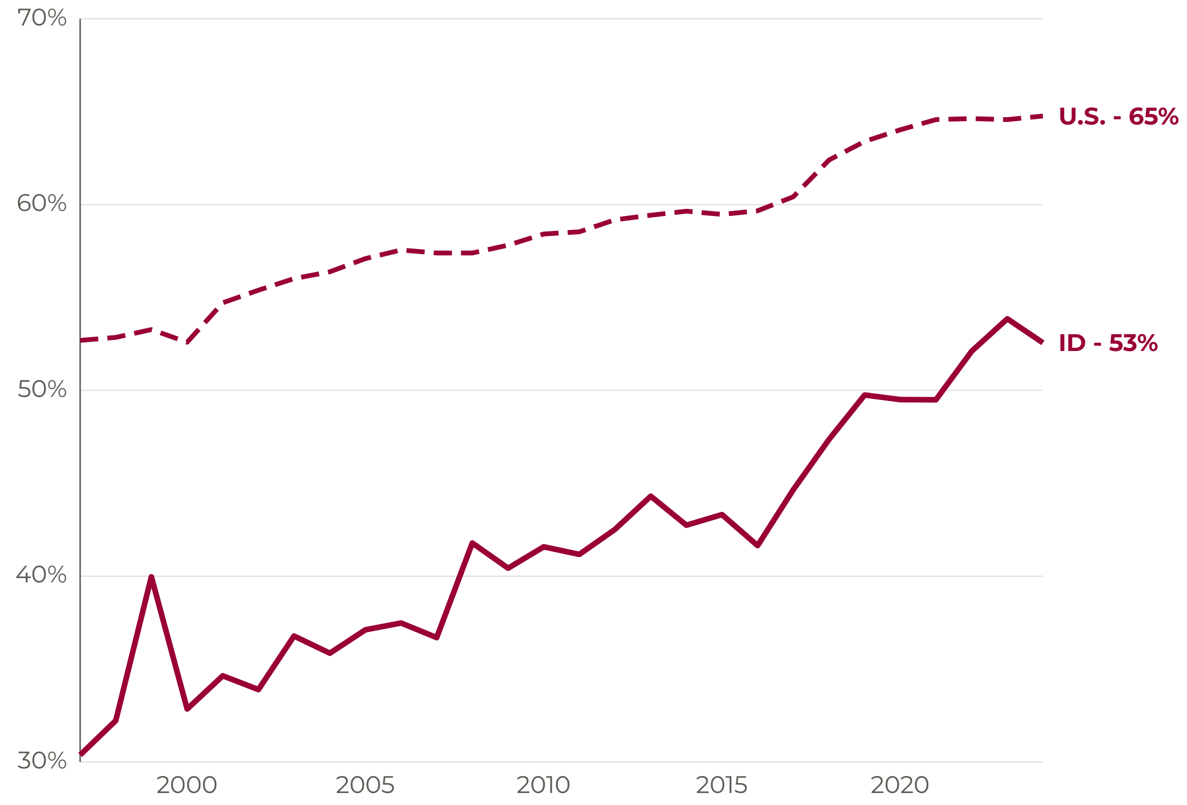
How Many of Idaho's Students Graduate?

The line follows the share of first-time, full-time bachelor's-degree students at Idaho's four-year institutions who graduated from the institution where they started within six years (150% of normal time). Each year is the cohort that entered six years earlier. The state is solid and the United States dashed.

Six-year graduation rate. The rate was 53% in 2024, against 65% for the U.S., down 1.3 points from 54% in 2023 and up 9.2 points since 2015, when it was 43%.

Public 4-year institutions. The rate was 52% in 2024, down 2.0 points from 54% in 2023 and up 10.6 points since 2015, when it was 42%.

Figure 37 Six-Year Bachelor's Graduation Rate



Four-year institutions; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

53%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · **47th** of 51

36%
Two-year completion rate, 2024
U.S. **41%** · **34th** of 50

11.6
Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025
U.S. **12.3** · **39th** of 51

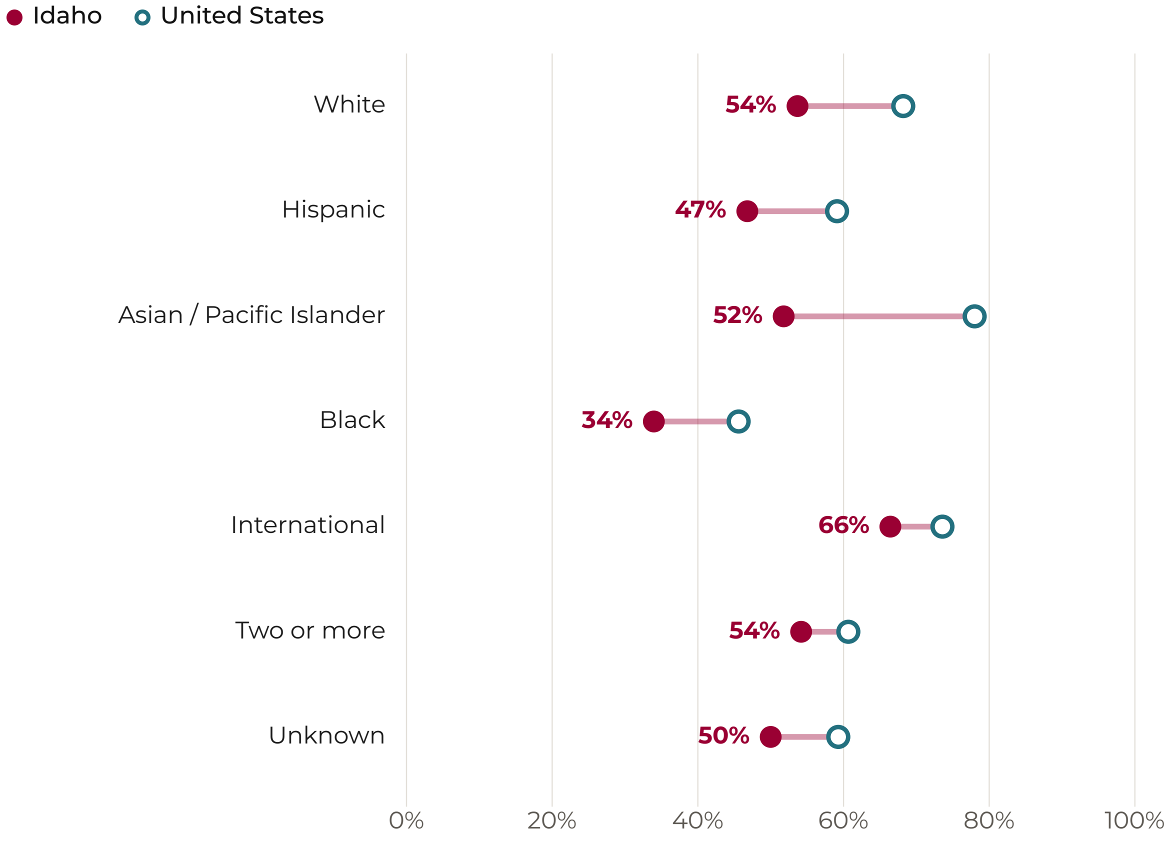
Each row is the six-year bachelor's graduation rate for one racial or ethnic group of students at Idaho's four-year institutions (filled dot), against the national rate for the same group (open dot). Groups with fewer than 100 students in the cohort are left out.

White. The six-year rate was 54% in 2024, against 68% for the U.S.

Hispanic. The six-year rate was 47% in 2024, against 59% for the U.S.

Asian / Pacific Islander. The six-year rate was 52% in 2024, against 78% for the U.S.

Figure 38 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Race and Ethnicity?



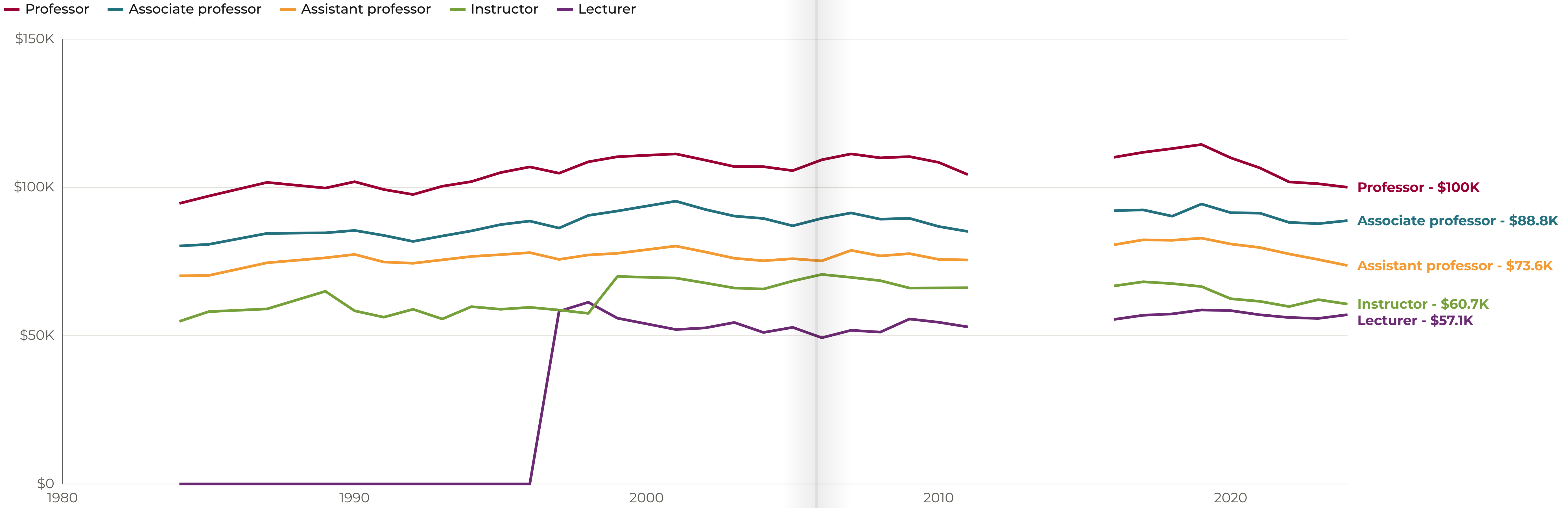
Six-year rate, 2024; groups with 100+ students. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 15

Faculty

Idaho ranks 44th of 51 states on the average full-time faculty salary, at $81.4K in 2024 against $106K for the U.S.

Figure 39 What Do Idaho's Faculty Earn, by Rank?



Average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts, by academic rank, 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS Human Resources.

Full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts at Idaho's institutions earned an average of $81.4K in 2024 (2024 dollars), 23% below the U.S. ($106K); the state ranks 44th of 51. By rank (2024): professors $100K, associate professors $88.8K, assistant professors $73.6K, instructors $60.7K, lecturers $57.1K.

Idaho's institutions had 3.52K full-time instructional staff in 2024, up 6% since 2015. Average salary across all ranks is down 5% since 2016.

$81.4K

Average faculty salary, 2024

U.S. **$106K** · **44th** of 51 · −4.6% since 2016

SECTION 15 · FACULTY

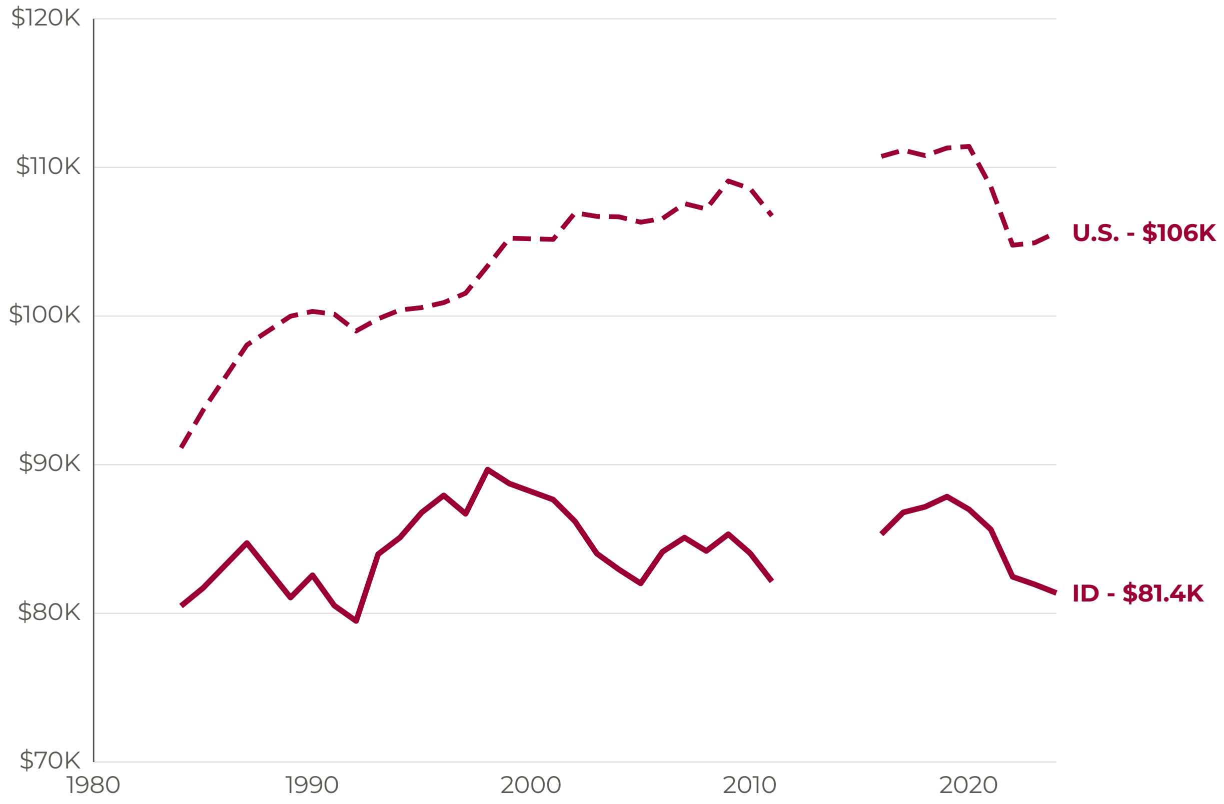
What Do Idaho's Faculty Earn, and How Many Hold Tenure?

The line follows the average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9- or 10-month contracts at Idaho's degree-granting institutions, all ranks combined, in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). The state is solid and the United States dashed.

Average salary. The figure was $81.4K in 2024, against $106K for the U.S., 44th among the states, down 0.7% from $81.9K in 2023 and down 4.6% since 2016, when it was $85.3K.

Full-time instructional staff. The number was 3.52K in 2024, up 1.6% from 3.46K in 2023 and up 5.7% since 2015, when it was 3.33K.

Figure 40 Average Faculty Salary



Full-time instructional faculty, 9/10-month, 2024 dollars. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

$81.4K
Average faculty salary, 2024
U.S. **$106K** · **44th** of 51

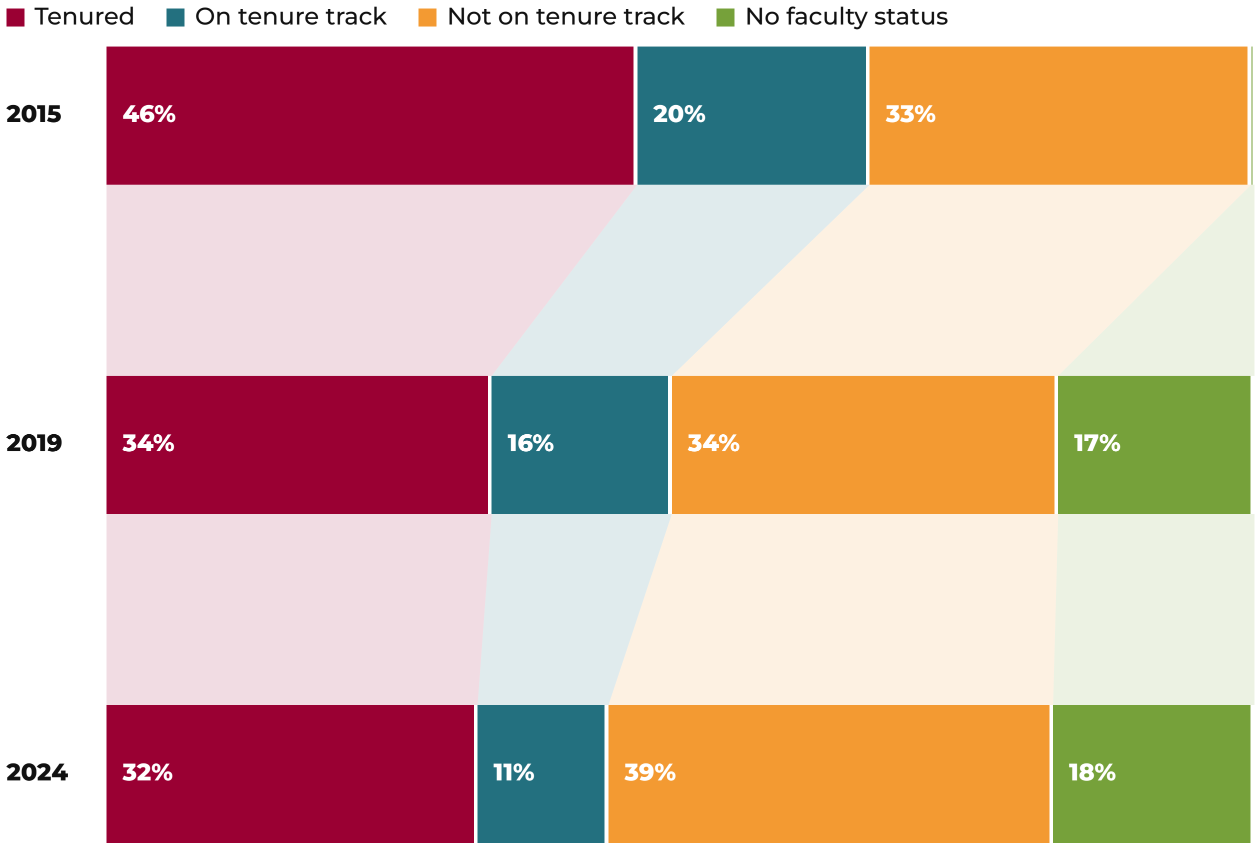
3.52K
Full-time instructional staff, 2024

32%
Tenured, 2024

The bars divide Idaho's full-time instructional staff by tenure status in 2015, 2019 and 2024: tenured, on the tenure track, not on the tenure track (for example, lecturers on fixed-term contracts), and staff at institutions with no tenure system.

Tenured, share of full-time instructional staff. The share was 32% in 2024, down 0.7 points from 33% in 2023 and down 13.9 points since 2015, when it was 46%.

Figure 41 Tenure Status



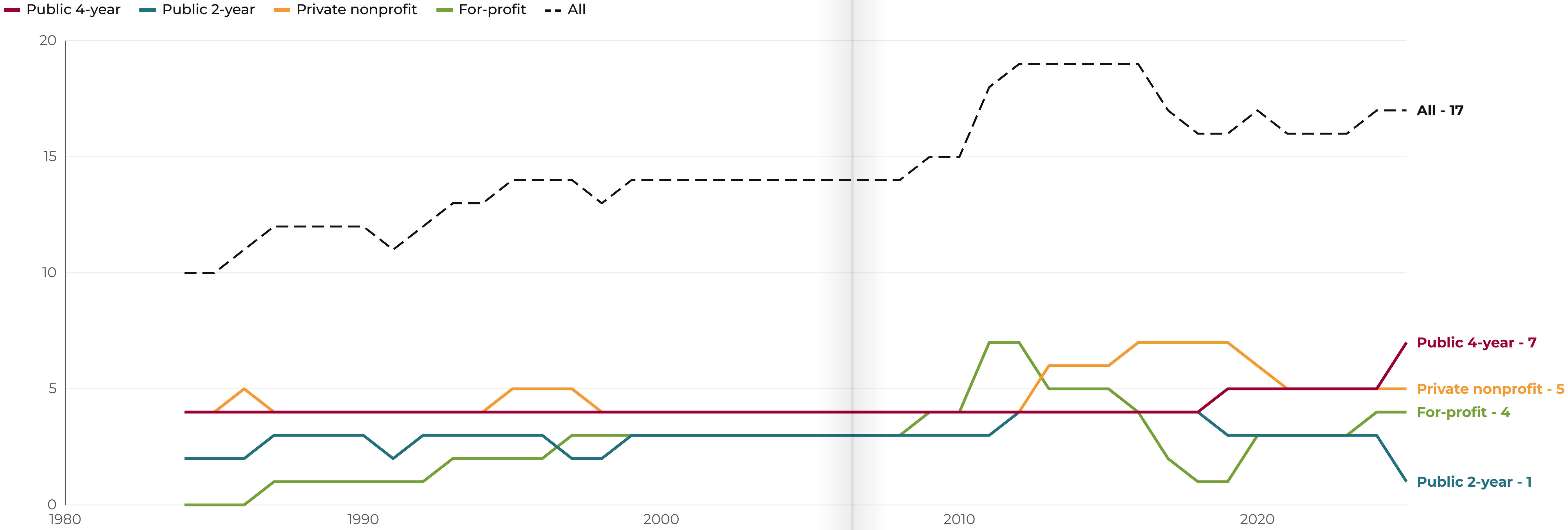
Full-time instructional staff by tenure status, 2015, 2019, 2024. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 16

Institutions

Idaho ranks 11th of 51 states on the share of students enrolled exclusively online, at 31% in 2024 against 27% for the U.S.

Figure 42 How Many Institutions Does Idaho Have?



Degree-granting institutions by sector. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Idaho has 17 degree-granting institutions:7 public 4-year, 1 public 2-year, 5 private nonprofit, 4 for-profit (2025).

The number of institutions is down 11% since 2015. 63% of students attend public institutions and 1.5% attend for-profit ones.

63%

Students at public institutions, 2024

U.S. **73%** · **39th** of 51 · +2.9 pp since 2015

1.5%

Students at for-profit institutions, 2024

U.S. **5.5%** · **27th** of 51 · +0.6 pp since 2015

31%

Students fully online, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **11th** of 51 · +2.6 pp since 2015

SECTION 16 · INSTITUTIONS

Which Institutions Lead in Idaho?

The table ranks institutions in Idaho by the STEM master's degrees and research doctorates they awarded to international students in 2025, the two counted together. The share columns give international students' share of each institution's STEM degrees at that level.

Largest. University of Idaho (35 international STEM master's degrees and 16 doctorates), Boise State University (24 international STEM master's degrees and 13 doctorates), and Idaho State University (19 international STEM master's degrees and – doctorates) awarded the most.

Table 8 Which Institutions Train the Most International STEM Graduates?

Institution	Intl STEM master's	Int. share	Intl STEM doctorates	Int. share
University of Idaho Moscow · Public 4-year	**35**	12%	16	39%
Boise State University Boise · Public 4-year	**24**	23%	13	28%
Idaho State University Pocatello · Public 4-year	**19**	42%	–	–%

Degrees awarded in 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

17
Degree-granting institutions, 2025

63%
Students at public institutions, 2024
U.S. **73%** · **39th** of 51

1.5%
Students at for-profit institutions, 2024
U.S. **5.5%** · **27th** of 51

31%
Students fully online, 2024
U.S. **27%** · **11th** of 51

The table lists Idaho's largest degree-granting institutions by fall 2024 headcount enrollment, with the international share of graduate students, STEM bachelor's degrees awarded in 2025, the six-year graduation rate and the admission rate (a dash where the institution admits all applicants or does not report one).

Largest. The three largest were Brigham Young University-Idaho (45.6K students), Boise State University (27.2K students), and Idaho State University (13.1K students).

Degree-granting institutions. The state had 17 in 2025, and 17 of them reported the enrollment and degree data in these tables.

Table 9 What Are Idaho's Largest Institutions?

Institution	Enrollment	Int. share, grad	STEM bachelor's	Six-year grad rate	Admit rate
Brigham Young University-Idaho	**45.6K**	–	1.67K	50%	96%
Boise State University	**27.2K**	6.6%	750	59%	87%
Idaho State University	**13.1K**	6.6%	183	35%	–
University of Idaho	**12.3K**	11%	514	57%	76%
College of Western Idaho	**11K**	–	–	–	–
College of Southern Idaho	**10.2K**	–	–	–	–
North Idaho College	**4.58K**	–	–	–	–
Lewis-Clark State College	**3.8K**	–	34	32%	88%
College of Eastern Idaho	**3.01K**	–	–	–	–
Northwest Nazarene University	**1.64K**	1.5%	55	71%	65%

Fall 2024 enrollment; degrees 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

NOTES

About These Data

International students

U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas, as IPEDS defines them. IPEDS does not record country of citizenship. Permanent residents count with U.S. citizens.

STEM

CIP families 03, 04, 11, 14, 15, 26, 27 and 40. Doctorates are research and scholarship doctorates; professional doctorates appear only in the degree-count figure. Degrees are first majors only.

Universe

Degree-granting institutions located in the state; Title IV participants from 1996. Geography is the institution's location, not the student's home. Enrollment is fall headcount.

Migration

First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by home state, reported in even years before 2001 and every year since; odd years with incomplete reporting are omitted. Net migration is students arriving from other states minus residents leaving, per 100 resident first-time students.

Money

All dollar values are in 2024 dollars using the CPI-U. Appropriations and revenue are per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions.

Race and ethnicity

IPEDS did not collect race and ethnicity in every year before 2010, and categories changed in 2008–2010; “Two or more” exists only from then.

Countries of citizenship

From DHS SEVIS by the Numbers: active F-1 and M-1 student records in the month named, at every level from primary school to doctorate, by the state of the school. IPEDS records only whether a student is a U.S. nonresident, not where they come from. SEVIS counts are monthly snapshots and are not directly comparable with IPEDS fall enrollment or degree counts.

Peers

Comparison states are the four closest in total fall enrollment.

Source

National Center for Education Statistics, Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS): Institutional Characteristics, Fall Enrollment, Completions, Graduation Rates, Finance, Human Resources and Admissions components, 1980–2025, harmonized into a state panel. Department of Homeland Security, SEVIS by the Numbers data mapping tool, 2014–2026. Generated November 2026.

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Idaho – By the Numbers

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION							
Grade 8 mathematics, average score	284	**278**^{2024}	−5.6 ▼	272	−9.0 ▼	#15	[5]
Grade 8 mathematics: at or above Proficient	34%	**31%**^{2024}	−3.1 pp ▼	27%	−5.3 pp ▼	#16	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics, average score	239	**238**^{2024}	−0.4 ▼	237	−2.5 ▼	#21	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics: at or above Proficient	38%	**41%**^{2024}	+2.6 pp ▲	39%	0.0 pp	#20	[5]
Grade 8 reading, average score	269	**261**^{2024}	−7.8 ▼	257	−7.3 ▼	#9	[5]
Grade 8 reading: at or above Proficient	37%	**32%**^{2024}	−5.3 pp ▼	29%	−4.0 pp ▼	#9	[5]
Grade 4 reading, average score	222	**216**^{2024}	−6.0 ▼	214	−7.1 ▼	#19	[5]
Grade 8 science, average score, 2009 framework	–	**160**^{2015}	–	153	–	#9	[5]
Current spending per public-school pupil	$9.06K	**$10.7K**^{2021}	+18% ▲	$16.8K	+12% ▲	#50	[3]
Public high school 4-year graduation rate, ACGR	79%	**80%**^{2022}	+1.0 pp ▲	87%	+4.0 pp ▲	#46	[3]
Public high school graduates	17.7K	**21.9K**^{2024}	+24% ▲	3.49M	+8.8% ▲	#37	[3]
Average public-school teacher salary	$59.1K	**$59.5K**^{2022}	+0.6% ▲	$72.9K	−3.0% ▼	#39	[3]
Pupils per teacher, public schools	18.7	**17.5**^{2022}	−1.2 ▼	15.4	−0.6 ▼	#9	[3]
Public elementary and secondary enrollment	292K	**316K**^{2024}	+8.0% ▲	49.4M	−2.1% ▼	#37	[3]
Public-school students eligible for free or reduced-price lunch	49%	**35%**^{2023}	−13.4 pp ▼	53%	+1.5 pp ▲	#42	[3]
English learners as a share of public-school students	4.4%	**5.8%**^{2022}	+1.4 pp ▲	11%	+1.0 pp ▲	#34	[3]
Charter-school share of public-school enrollment	6.6%	**9.0%**^{2023}	+2.4 pp ▲	7.6%	+2.2 pp ▲	#13	[3]
High schools offering calculus	51%^{2016}	**42%**^{2024}	−8.6 pp ▼	51%	−5.8 pp ▼	#35	[14]
High schools offering physics	46%^{2016}	**45%**^{2024}	−0.2 pp ▼	64%	−2.4 pp ▼	#44	[14]
High schools offering chemistry	61%^{2016}	**58%**^{2024}	−2.3 pp ▼	81%	+0.7 pp ▲	#50	[14]
High schools offering Algebra II	78%^{2016}	**71%**^{2024}	−6.7 pp ▼	87%	+1.3 pp ▲	#49	[14]
High schools offering computer science	46%^{2021}	**38%**^{2024}	−8.3 pp ▼	55%	+2.0 pp ▲	#46	[14]
High schools offering any AP course	31%^{2016}	**29%**^{2024}	−1.8 pp ▼	56%	0.0 pp	#45	[14]
High schools offering AP computer science	7.7%^{2021}	**8.5%**^{2024}	+0.8 pp ▲	25%	+2.6 pp ▲	#45	[14]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

IDAHO – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION (CONTINUED)							
High schools offering dual enrollment	71%^{2016}	**73%**^{2024}	+1.5 pp ▲	71%	+11.1 pp ▲	#33	[14]
AP course enrollments per 100 high-school students	11.0^{2016}	**9.9**^{2024}	−1.1 ▼	18.4	+1.0 ▲	#48	[14]
Calculus enrollments per 100 high-school students	4.2^{2016}	**3.1**^{2024}	−1.1 ▼	3.3	−1.0 ▼	#22	[14]
Physics enrollments per 100 high-school students	4.6^{2016}	**5.2**^{2024}	+0.6 ▲	9.4	−0.4 ▼	#38	[14]
SAT or ACT takers per 100 high-school students	21.5^{2016}	**12.9**^{2024}	−8.6 ▼	18.1	−2.5 ▼	#42	[14]
Students in gifted and talented programs per 100 students	2.5^{2016}	**3.9**^{2024}	+1.4 ▲	7.0	+0.4 ▲	#30	[14]
ENROLLMENT AND INSTITUTIONS							
Pell Grant share of undergraduates	39%	**25%**^{2025}	−13.3 pp ▼	36%	−0.8 pp ▼	#49	[15]
Fall enrollment	121K	**136K**^{2024}	+12% ▲	19.7M	−1.7% ▼	#38	[4]
Share of enrollment at public institutions	60%	**63%**^{2024}	+2.9 pp ▲	73%	0.0 pp	#39	[4]
Share of enrollment at for-profit institutions	0.9%	**1.5%**^{2024}	+0.6 pp ▲	5.5%	−1.2 pp ▼	#27	[4]
Share of students enrolled part-time	49%	**53%**^{2024}	+3.4 pp ▲	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#2	[4]
Share of students who are graduate students	6.5%	**7.0%**^{2024}	+0.5 pp ▲	17%	+2.0 pp ▲	#51	[4]
Share of students enrolled exclusively online	28%	**31%**^{2024}	+2.6 pp ▲	27%	+12.1 pp ▲	#11	[4]
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY							
Research doctorates awarded	115	**145**^{2025}	+26% ▲	59K	+7.3% ▲	#46	[7]
Science & engineering research doctorates, excluding health	82	**105**^{2025}	+28% ▲	44.4K	+14% ▲	#47	[7]
Share of U.S. research doctorates	0.2%	**0.2%**^{2025}	0.0 pp	–	–	#46	[7]
Engineering research doctorates	19	**21**^{2025}	–	10.9K	+9.9% ▲	#46	[7]
Mathematics & computer science research doctorates	4	**13**^{2025}	–	5.07K	+33% ▲	#42	[7]
STEM master's degrees per research doctorate	4.6	**4.7**^{2025}	+0.1 ▲	6.4	+2.1 ▲	#34	[4]
STEM share of bachelor's	19%	**22%**^{2025}	+2.9 pp ▲	24%	+5.3 pp ▲	#27	[4]
Share of bachelor's in computer & information sciences	3.1%	**7.4%**^{2025}	+4.2 pp ▲	6.9%	+3.7 pp ▲	#14	[4]
Share of bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology	5.3%	**5.2%**^{2025}	−0.1 pp ▼	6.8%	+0.7 pp ▲	#38	[4]
Share of bachelor's in mathematics & statistics	0.9%	**0.7%**^{2025}	−0.2 pp ▼	1.2%	0.0 pp	#34	[4]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). “pp” is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

IDAHO – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY (CONTINUED)							
Share of bachelor's in biological & biomedical sciences	6.5%	**6.5%^{2025}**	0.0 pp	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#26	[4]
Share of bachelor's in physical sciences	1.9%	**0.9%^{2025}**	−0.9 pp ▼	1.3%	−0.3 pp ▼	#43	[4]
Share of bachelor's in health professions	14%	**16%^{2025}**	+1.9 pp ▲	12%	+1.1 pp ▲	#10	[4]
Share of bachelor's in business	15%	**19%^{2025}**	+3.4 pp ▲	19%	−0.1 pp ▼	#29	[4]
STEM share of master's	19%	**18%^{2025}**	−0.4 pp ▼	23%	+6.7 pp ▲	#31	[4]
Share of master's in computer & information sciences	1.0%	**1.9%^{2025}**	+0.9 pp ▲	10%	+6.3 pp ▲	#47	[4]
Share of master's in engineering & eng. technology	7.1%	**4.7%^{2025}**	−2.4 pp ▼	6.7%	−0.2 pp ▼	#34	[4]
Share of master's in mathematics & statistics	0.8%	**0.8%^{2025}**	0.0 pp	1.3%	+0.3 pp ▲	#33	[4]
Share of master's in biological & biomedical sciences	1.4%	**1.6%^{2025}**	+0.1 pp ▲	2.5%	+0.6 pp ▲	#41	[4]
Share of master's in physical sciences	1.8%	**1.4%^{2025}**	−0.5 pp ▼	0.8%	−0.1 pp ▼	#13	[4]
Share of master's in health professions	12%	**19%^{2025}**	+6.4 pp ▲	15%	+1.7 pp ▲	#7	[4]
Share of master's in business	16%	**16%^{2025}**	−0.5 pp ▼	21%	−3.2 pp ▼	#45	[4]
STEM share of research doctorates	53%	**46%^{2025}**	−6.7 pp ▼	39%	−2.2 pp ▼	#16	[4]
Share of research doctorates in computer & information sciences	2.0%	**9.5%^{2025}**	+7.5 pp ▲	4.2%	+1.4 pp ▲	#4	[4]
Share of research doctorates in engineering & eng. technology	16%	**13%^{2025}**	−3.5 pp ▼	14%	−1.0 pp ▼	#27	[4]
Share of research doctorates in mathematics & statistics	1.3%	**0.5%^{2025}**	−0.8 pp ▼	2.4%	−0.2 pp ▼	#47	[4]
Share of research doctorates in biological & biomedical sciences	8.7%	**12%^{2025}**	+3.3 pp ▲	10%	−1.1 pp ▼	#24	[4]
Share of research doctorates in physical sciences	8.7%	**7.5%^{2025}**	−1.2 pp ▼	7.1%	−1.1 pp ▼	#27	[4]
Share of research doctorates in health professions	4.0%	**6.5%^{2025}**	+2.5 pp ▲	12%	+3.5 pp ▲	#35	[4]
Share of research doctorates in business	0.0%	**0.0%^{2025}**	0.0 pp	5.6%	+1.3 pp ▲	#48	[4]
Bachelor's degrees per 100 undergraduates	9.8	**11.6^{2025}**	+1.8 ▲	12.3	+1.4 ▲	#39	[4]
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS							
First-time students from outside the U.S.	2.3%^{2016}	**13%^{2024}**	+10.8 pp ▲	3.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#1	[4]
STEM master's degrees earned by international students	52	**78^{2025}**	+50% ▲	117K	2.18× ▲	#44	[4]
Share of all U.S. international STEM master's degrees	0.1%	**0.1%^{2025}**	0.0 pp	–	–	#44	[4]

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IDAHO – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
International share of undergraduate enrollment	7.9%	**2.1%**^{2024}	−5.9 pp ▼	3.0%	−0.3 pp ▼	#34	[4]
International share of graduate enrollment	6.8%	**6.9%**^{2024}	+0.1 pp ▲	17%	+2.8 pp ▲	#44	[4]
International share of all bachelor's	3.4%	**2.5%**^{2025}	−0.9 pp ▼	4.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#38	[4]
International share of STEM bachelor's	5.6%	**4.8%**^{2025}	−0.8 pp ▼	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#28	[4]
International share of all master's	5.8%	**6.4%**^{2025}	+0.6 pp ▲	22%	+6.2 pp ▲	#45	[4]
International share of STEM master's	14%	**18%**^{2025}	+3.8 pp ▲	52%	+9.1 pp ▲	#44	[4]
International share of computer & information sciences master's	52%^{2020}	**49%**^{2025}	−3.4 pp ▼	65%	+8.5 pp ▲	#31	[4]
International share of engineering & eng. technology master's	18%	**28%**^{2025}	+9.7 pp ▲	50%	+0.9 pp ▲	#41	[4]
International share of mathematics & statistics master's	–	**25%**^{2008}	–	36%	–	#31	[4]
International share of biological & biomedical sciences master's	6.1%^{2016}	**11%**^{2025}	+4.8 pp ▲	23%	+6.9 pp ▲	#41	[4]
International share of physical sciences master's	19%	**16%**^{2025}	−3.8 pp ▼	33%	+3.6 pp ▲	#41	[4]
International share of all research doctorates	21%	**18%**^{2025}	−2.7 pp ▼	25%	−1.0 pp ▼	#38	[4]
International share of STEM research doctorates	35%	**32%**^{2025}	−3.9 pp ▼	43%	−0.5 pp ▼	#45	[4]
International share of engineering & eng. technology research doctorates	36%^{2020}	**34%**^{2024}	−2.2 pp ▼	56%	−4.4 pp ▼	#43	[4]
Active F-1/M-1 students, all levels	4.43K	**3.47K**^{2026}	−22% ▼	1.19M	−0.1% ▼	#40	[20]
Share of U.S. active F-1/M-1 students	0.4%	**0.3%**^{2026}	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#40	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from India	2.8%	**4.7%**^{2026}	+1.9 pp ▲	27%	+11.4 pp ▲	#48	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from China	9.8%	**3.1%**^{2026}	−6.7 pp ▼	18%	−11.7 pp ▼	#47	[20]
Share from the two largest countries of origin	44%	**22%**^{2026}	−22.4 pp ▼	45%	−0.3 pp ▼	#44	[20]
Countries of citizenship represented	138	**146**^{2026}	+5.8% ▲	219	−2.7% ▼	#37	[20]
Active STEM F-1/M-1 students	2.22K	**2.26K**^{2026}	+1.5% ▲	749K	+61% ▲	#41	[20]
Active STEM master's students	179	**406**^{2026}	2.27× ▲	393K	+90% ▲	#44	[20]
Active STEM doctoral students	166	**428**^{2026}	2.58× ▲	158K	+61% ▲	#44	[20]
Share of STEM master's students from India	27%	**49%**^{2026}	+22.4 pp ▲	58%	−1.8 pp ▼	#34	[20]

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IDAHO – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
U.S. students studying abroad for credit, from the state's institutions	778^{2017}	**580^{2024}**	−25% ▼	–	–	#46	[1]
Economic contribution of international students	\$82.8M^{2018}	**\$85.5M^{2024}**	+3.3% ▲	\$42.9B	+4.6% ▲	#42	[2]
Jobs supported by international students' spending	762^{2018}	**586^{2024}**	−23% ▼	356K	−22% ▼	#42	[2]
Share of U.S. student and exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	0.3%	**0.2%^{2024}**	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#45	[16]
Share of U.S. F-1 student admissions, by destination	0.3%	**0.2%^{2024}**	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#44	[16]
Share of U.S. J-1 exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	0.2%	**0.3%^{2024}**	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#43	[16]
J-1 exchange visitors starting a program in the state	1.35K	**1.44K^{2025}**	+6.7% ▲	275K	−14% ▼	#40	[18]
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH							
Graduate students in science & engineering	1.75K	**1.77K^{2016}**	+1.1% ▲	620K	+0.4% ▲	#45	[9]
S&E graduate students on temporary visas	322	**341^{2016}**	+5.9% ▲	241K	+2.3% ▲	#46	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E graduate students	18%	**19%^{2016}**	+0.9 pp ▲	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#48	[9]
Temporary-visa share of engineering graduate students	28%	**29%^{2016}**	+1.6 pp ▲	57%	0.0 pp	#49	[9]
S&E postdoctoral appointees	63	**89^{2016}**	+41% ▲	45.7K	+1.0% ▲	#42	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E postdocs	56%	**57%^{2016}**	+1.7 pp ▲	56%	−0.9 pp ▼	#21	[9]
University R&D spending	\$147M	**\$216M^{2024}**	+47% ▲	\$118B	+71% ▲	#49	[6]
Share of U.S. university R&D	0.2%	**0.2%^{2024}**	0.0 pp	–	–	#49	[6]
Federally funded share of university R&D	55%	**51%^{2024}**	−4.3 pp ▼	55%	−0.2 pp ▼	#32	[6]
Business-funded share of university R&D	2.1%	**1.1%^{2024}**	−1.0 pp ▼	5.4%	−0.4 pp ▼	#47	[6]
State- and locally funded share of university R&D	20%	**26%^{2024}**	+5.2 pp ▲	5.2%	−0.4 pp ▼	#1	[6]
University R&D in mathematics and computer science	\$6.16M	**\$12.9M^{2024}**	2.10× ▲	\$5.12B	+97% ▲	#42	[6]
University R&D in engineering	\$23.9M	**\$39M^{2024}**	+63% ▲	\$19.3B	+74% ▲	#46	[6]
University R&D personnel, headcount	3.34K	**4.32K^{2024}**	+30% ▲	1.09M	+20% ▲	#42	[6]
Federal R&D obligations to the state	\$533M	**\$918M^{2024}**	+72% ▲	\$193B	+53% ▲	#30	[8]
Federal R&D obligations to universities in the state	\$92.3M	**\$78M^{2024}**	−16% ▼	\$44.4B	+64% ▲	#50	[8]
Defense R&D obligations to the state	\$25M	**\$150M^{2024}**	6.00× ▲	\$97.2B	+60% ▲	#37	[8]

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IDAHO – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH (CONTINUED)							
Health (HHS/NIH) R&D obligations to the state	\$11.8M	**\$22.5M**^{2024}	+92% ▲	\$48.5B	+62% ▲	#49	[8]
NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science grants performed in the state	\$41.8M	**\$99.6M**^{2025}	2.39× ▲	\$45B	+47% ▲	#44	[19]
Federal R&D contracts performed in the state	\$4.02M	**\$15.2M**^{2026}	+11.2 ▲	\$59.3B	+22,105.9 ▲	#45	[19]
COLLEGE COSTS AND OUTCOMES							
Median earnings 10 years after entering college	\$48.9K^{2020}	**\$50.9K**^{2022}	+4.2% ▲	\$47.5K	+11% ▲	#19	[15]
Median earnings 1 year after completing	–	**\$45.3K**^{2025}	–	\$47.5K	–	#40	[15]
Median debt of completers	\$11K	**\$15.5K**^{2024}	+41% ▲	\$17.6K	-4.6% ▼	#45	[15]
STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**\$70.5K**^{2025}	–	\$68.2K	–	#13	[15]
Non-STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**\$44.6K**^{2025}	–	\$51.9K	–	#48	[15]
Bachelor's graduates: median earnings 5 years out	–	**\$61.2K**^{2025}	–	\$68.1K	–	#44	[15]
STEM master's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**\$64K**^{2025}	–	\$91.6K	–	#44	[15]
Six-year bachelor's graduation rate, 4-year institutions	43%	**53%**^{2024}	+9.2 pp ▲	65%	+5.3 pp ▲	#47	[4]
Completion within 150% of normal time, 2-year institutions	21%	**36%**^{2024}	+14.5 pp ▲	41%	+12.1 pp ▲	#34	[4]
In-state tuition & fees, public 4-year	\$9.15K	**\$8.18K**^{2023}	-11% ▼	\$9.71K	-14% ▼	#39	[4]
State & local appropriations per FTE, public institutions	\$9.89K	**\$11K**^{2024}	+11% ▲	\$11.4K	+22% ▲	#26	[4]
Tuition share of core revenue, public institutions	46%	**42%**^{2024}	-3.8 pp ▼	43%	-5.9 pp ▼	#30	[4]
Average full-time faculty salary (9/10-month)	\$85.3K^{2016}	**\$81.4K**^{2024}	-4.6% ▼	\$106K	-4.6% ▼	#44	[4]
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO							
International graduates on OPT working in the state where they studied	30%	**34%**^{2016}	+3.8 pp ▲	44%	-1.8 pp ▼	#28	[21]
OPT retention, bachelor's graduates	32%	**32%**^{2016}	-0.2 pp ▼	58%	+0.3 pp ▲	#42	[21]
OPT retention, master's graduates	38%	**41%**^{2016}	+3.7 pp ▲	39%	-2.5 pp ▼	#20	[21]
OPT retention, STEM graduates	23%	**29%**^{2016}	+6.1 pp ▲	37%	-1.9 pp ▼	#27	[21]
OPT workers employed in the state per OPT graduate of its schools	1.15	**1.00**^{2016}	-0.2 ▼	1.00	0.0	#16	[21]
STEM OPT extensions approved, by state of the school	66	**46**^{2016}	-30% ▼	41.2K	+51% ▲	#45	[21]

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IDAHO – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO (CONTINUED)							
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year after graduating (PSEO)	32%^{2016}	**34%**^{2019}	+2.0 pp ▲	72%	−0.1 pp ▼	#32	[11]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 5 years after graduating (PSEO)	–	**24%**^{2016}	–	65%	–	#35	[11]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 10 years after graduating (PSEO)	–	**25%**^{2010}	–	64%	–	#32	[11]
STEM bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	30%^{2016}	**31%**^{2019}	+0.2 pp ▲	67%	+1.5 pp ▲	#31	[11]
Bachelor's graduates' median earnings 1 year out (PSEO)	$40.5K^{2016}	**$43.3K**^{2019}	+6.9% ▲	$48.1K	+2.3% ▲	#30	[11]
Bachelor's graduates' median earnings 5 years out (PSEO)	–	**$62.4K**^{2016}	–	$67.3K	–	#25	[11]
STEM bachelor's graduates' median earnings 1 year out (PSEO)	$53.5K^{2016}	**$54.8K**^{2019}	+2.4% ▲	$59.3K	+0.1% ▲	#26	[11]
Net domestic migration of bachelor's-plus adults, per 1,000 residents	+8.2	**+5.8**^{2025}	−2.4 ▼	–	–	#9	[12]
Net domestic migration of graduate-degree holders	+1.89K	**+873**^{2025}	−1,020.0 ▼	–	–	#17	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved in from another state	4.9%	**3.4%**^{2025}	−1.5 pp ▼	–	–	#15	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved out to another state	4.0%	**2.8%**^{2025}	−1.3 pp ▼	–	–	#22	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who arrived from abroad in the past year	1.92K	**2.11K**^{2025}	+10% ▲	–	–	#39	[12]
First-time students who are in-state residents	60%^{2016}	**54%**^{2024}	−6.0 pp ▼	–	–	#46	[4]
Net student migration (per 100 resident first-time students)	+19^{2016}	**+19**^{2024}	−0.2 ▼	–	–	#15	[4]
Recent high school graduates who go to college out of state	27%^{2016}	**27%**^{2022}	+0.4 pp ▲	22%	+2.5 pp ▲	#18	[3]
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS							
Certified H-1B positions, by worksite	1.39K	**1.1K**^{2025}	−21% ▼	914K	−24% ▼	#41	[17]
Share of U.S. certified H-1B positions	0.1%	**0.1%**^{2025}	0.0 pp	–	–	#41	[17]
STEM share of certified H-1B positions	84%	**78%**^{2025}	−5.5 pp ▼	76%	−7.8 pp ▼	#14	[17]
Median offered H-1B wage, nominal dollars	$70K	**$104K**^{2025}	+49% ▲	$119K	+66% ▲	#23	[17]
H-1B positions at H-1B-dependent employers	36%	**10%**^{2025}	−25.5 pp ▼	22%	−25.7 pp ▼	#38	[17]
Green-card labor certifications	90	**351**^{2025}	3.90× ▲	138K	+75% ▲	#39	[17]
Share of PERM certifications for citizens of India	31%	**25%**^{2024}	−5.8 pp ▼	47%	−10.6 pp ▼	#36	[17]

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IDAHO – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS (CONTINUED)							
PERM certifications for workers on F-1 student visas	1.1%	**19%^{2024}**	+17.5 pp ▲	8.7%	+4.9 pp ▲	#6	[17]
PERM workers with a master's or doctorate	61%	**43%^{2024}**	−18.0 pp ▼	47%	−4.9 pp ▼	#23	[17]
STEM share of PERM certifications	70%	**26%^{2025}**	−43.5 pp ▼	49%	−25.8 pp ▼	#35	[17]
Median offered PERM wage, nominal dollars	$79.6K	**$35.4K^{2025}**	−56% ▼	$100K	+9.9% ▲	#46	[17]
New lawful permanent residents (green cards), by state of residence	2.53K	**2.53K^{2024}**	−0.0% ▼	1.36M	+30% ▲	#41	[16]
Share of U.S. new green-card holders	0.2%	**0.2%^{2024}**	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#41	[16]
People naturalized as U.S. citizens, by state of residence	1.43K	**1.86K^{2024}**	+30% ▲	819K	+12% ▲	#40	[16]
Share of U.S. naturalizations	0.2%	**0.2%^{2024}**	0.0 pp	–	–	#40	[16]
Share of U.S. temporary-worker admissions, by destination	0.1%	**0.3%^{2024}**	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#37	[16]
Share of U.S. H-1B worker admissions, by destination	0.1%	**0.1%^{2024}**	0.0 pp	–	–	#46	[16]
Share of U.S. L-1 intracompany-transferee admissions, by destination	0.1%	**0.2%^{2024}**	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#39	[16]
Share of U.S. O-1 extraordinary-ability worker admissions, by destination	0.0%	**0.1%^{2024}**	0.0 pp	–	–	#42	[16]
New H-1B approvals (initial), by employer state	112	**363^{2026}**	3.24× ▲	127K	+14% ▲	#37	[13]
Continuing H-1B approvals, by employer state	192	**502^{2026}**	2.61× ▲	268K	+52% ▲	#40	[13]
Share of U.S. new H-1B approvals	0.1%	**0.3%^{2026}**	+0.2 pp ▲	–	–	#37	[13]
Denial rate, new H-1B petitions	2.6%	**3.5%^{2026}**	+0.8 pp ▲	3.4%	−3.0 pp ▼	#26	[13]
New H-1B approvals at colleges and schools (NAICS 61)	22%	**9.4%^{2026}**	−13.0 pp ▼	8.6%	−1.7 pp ▼	#40	[13]
New H-1B approvals in professional, scientific & technical services	8.9%	**15%^{2026}**	+6.2 pp ▲	44%	−12.5 pp ▼	#43	[13]
Five largest employers' share of new H-1B approvals	71%	**75%^{2026}**	+4.7 pp ▲	9.1%	−6.7 pp ▼	#1	[13]
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION							
Workers in STEM occupations	37.8K	**70.1K^{2024}**	+86% ▲	13.7M	+51% ▲	#36	[12]
STEM workers as a share of all workers	5.0%	**7.2%^{2024}**	+2.2 pp ▲	8.1%	+2.1 pp ▲	#29	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers	7.5%	**8.8%^{2024}**	+1.3 pp ▲	24%	+1.6 pp ▲	#42	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers with a graduate degree	18%^{2021}	**22%^{2024}**	+3.5 pp ▲	41%	+1.3 pp ▲	#34	[12]

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IDAHO – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION (CONTINUED)							
Noncitizen share of STEM workers	5.4%	**5.3%^{2024}**	0.0 pp	11%	+0.7 pp ▲	#38	[12]
STEM workers born abroad who arrived in the last 10 years	3.4%	**4.7%^{2024}**	+1.3 pp ▲	7.5%	+0.3 pp ▲	#28	[12]
Foreign-born share of residents	5.7%	**6.0%^{2025}**	+0.3 pp ▲	15%	+1.3 pp ▲	#37	[12]
Foreign-born share of graduate-degree holders, 25+	7.4%	**8.1%^{2025}**	+0.7 pp ▲	21%	+2.8 pp ▲	#44	[12]
STEM jobs, employer survey	37.9K	**50.7K^{2025}**	+34% ▲	10.4M	+26% ▲	#39	[10]
STEM jobs concentration vs the U.S., location quotient	0.99	**0.89^{2025}**	−0.1 ▼	1.00	0.0	#27	[10]
Mean annual STEM wage, nominal	$71.4K	**$100K^{2025}**	+40% ▲	$120K	+38% ▲	#36	[10]
Median software developer wage, nominal	$93.4K^{2019}	**$132K^{2025}**	+41% ▲	$136K	+26% ▲	#17	[10]
Software developer jobs	3.48K^{2016}	**5.75K^{2025}**	+65% ▲	1.69M	+40% ▲	#36	[10]
Mean annual wage, all occupations, nominal	$40.8K	**$61.2K^{2025}**	+50% ▲	$69.8K	+44% ▲	#37	[10]
Patents granted to assignees in the state	1.09K	**1.56K^{2025}**	+43% ▲	135K	−0.6% ▼	#21	[22]
Share of U.S.-assignee patents	0.8%	**1.2%^{2025}**	+0.4 pp ▲	–	–	#21	[22]
Share of the state's patents in digital technologies	45%	**67%^{2025}**	+22.3 pp ▲	43%	+1.6 pp ▲	#3	[22]
Share of the state's patents in life sciences	1.8%	**0.8%^{2025}**	−1.0 pp ▼	17%	+0.4 pp ▲	#51	[22]
Share of the state's patents in semiconductors	42%	**23%^{2025}**	−18.8 pp ▼	2.9%	−1.7 pp ▼	#1	[22]
Women's share of inventors on the state's patents	7.3%	**14%^{2025}**	+6.5 pp ▲	14%	+3.4 pp ▲	#16	[22]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

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